scream out my name like you mean it

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/27089119.

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Mature

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Character:
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Additional Tags:
Alternate Universe - Celebrity, Enemies to Friends to Lovers, Miscommunication, Angst, Misunderstandings, scandals, media gossip, Fame, Adora is a famous actor, Catra becomes a famous actor, Adora and Catra are co stars, Happy Ending, Hurt/Comfort, Sexual Tension, Sex, Childhood Trauma, mentions of abuse, Mentions of homelessness, Multimedia, Catra is REALLY angry, They fight a lot, But they're in love the whole time, Catra is a magicat

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by ThisWriterD

Summary

Catra auditions for the role of the new antagonist in the hit teen drama show, Wolf Spring. She draws on every bit of anger, hurt and betrayal that still sits heavy in her chest, and she grabs the role easily. The catch? Adora plays the main character. Their troubled childhood looms over them, and Catra is unwilling to even talk to Adora. Because after all, Adora was the one to betray her so many years ago.

Adora does not expect to walk into the audition room to see Catra right there, after so many years. Even more confusing is still having no idea what she really did to make Catra hate her so much. Adora is happy for her, getting the role. But Catra is infuriating, and just as their characters are at each other's throats, so are they.

When season 5 of Wolf Spring airs, they are all caught off guard by the instant popularity of not only Catra, but the relationship between her character and Adora's. Media, paparazzi and crazy fans shipping them and their characters make a complicated situation even more so.

Notes

I am a little bit terrified to finally post this, but here it is! Read my end note for some more info. Also let me just put it out there that I have no clue how hollywood works and I'm running just on google and what I've seen in movies/books so please don't expect an accurate representation of movie/series filming lol. This is a fanfic so just shhh and enjoy the gay drama

Take One, Meet Your Enemy

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

There was a popular saying— 'like a magicat in water'. If one was distraught enough, uncomfortable enough, they would be told they looked like a magicat in water. It was often used as an insult, and magicats particularly took offence to this.

Catra, for once, was a literal magicat in water. She was uncomfortable to a degree, but certainly not because of the deep tub she was currently lounging in. She had her speakers on full blast, the bass rumbling through the house in the perfect combination of *too loud* and *distracting*.

Still, Catra couldn't help herself. She was in her favourite bath, soaking in rose scented water with a comically large goblet of wine on a small table nearby. On any other day, this would be pure bliss. Catra often liked to banish social media, especially her cellphone, when she took to the bath. This was her time to self-reflect, to go over her lines and analyse the day's interactions.

But no, this time she was breaking her own damn rules, and she was growing more irritated by the second. The wine was still sweet on her tongue, but she was biting down hard on it, trying not to break skin and bleed.

Her latest movie had gone to theatres, and the reviews were in— and they were all negative. Catra wasn't so weak that a few nasty comments could beat her down. No, her childhood had done enough of that to her that she knew how to shove it down and aside, ignore it like a scabbing wound. What was irritating her *particularly* was the near lack of comment on *her*. For once, she hadn't been a two-second background character. Sure, her role hadn't been that big. Her script had been three pages in total. But still, it was more than Catra had gotten in a long time.

It was easy to get the toothpaste adverts, the modelling for new gardening tools and the like. But the real challenge was getting a role for something big. Something that would put all eyes on her, that would make people recognize her.

That thought, and the memories that it brought up, made the sweetness on her tongue turn bitter. She was half tempted to simply toss her phone in the bath water, so done with everything in the dampness of her mood.

But no, her music switched off and she heard familiar heels clicking on her floor before the bathroom door burst open with flourish. Double Trouble filled the doorway, their pale blonde hair spilling over one shoulder. They glanced about the room, eyes lingering on the cellphone in her hand.

"DT," Catra sighed. She dropped her phone on the table and grabbed her massive glass. "What is it?"

Double Trouble was undeterred by her sour tone and mood. This, of course, was the norm. They were quite similar in personality, though they had more of a spicy bite to their attitude. Catra was more fiery resentment and bitterness, Double Trouble was always vindictive amusement.

"Kitten," Double Trouble purred. They stalked over to sit graciously on the edge of Catra's tub. "I have the most delectable news."

Catra relaxed in the water, ears twitching at the sound of sloshing against the tub edges. "What news?"

Double Trouble's grin split wide around their sharp teeth. They were always a little terrifying around all that beauty, and Catra sometimes envied their complete ease with which they just let themself *be.* They were both the most secretive and honest person Catra had ever met, and that was why they got along so well. That, and they were both terrible people.

"A certain popular teen drama show just announced their need for a new actress."

Catra took a heavy sip of wine. She was already missing her music and the relief it offered. “So?”

“So, darling,” Double Trouble purred. They slid down to the floor to rest their arms along the edge, regarding Catra with undisguised enthralment. This grabbed Catra’s attention, making her sit up straight and set her glass down. Neither of them cared about the state of her nakedness. Double Trouble had already seen way more than her tits, and once Catra shared her deepest pain and trauma with someone, there were no boundaries left. There had only ever been *one* other person that Catra had trusted her heart with. And that, well, had ended rather badly. She would *not* be doing that again. Double Trouble was the exception. “You’re aware of that obnoxious show Wolf Spring, yes?”

Catra let out a groan. “Of course I know that show.”

Double Trouble’s grin only broadened. They knew this too, of course. They knew everything, so when Catra’s ears pressed flat, Double Trouble understood immediately that she was already pulling away, her irritation flaring. If this wasn’t good, she was about to snap.

“Well, casting wants a devious lady to play the part of their shiny new antagonist.” Double Trouble lifted their phone, showing the ad description. Catra leaned forward to read it, her tail sticking out of the water and draped over the edge, dripping water onto the floor with every irritated flick. “The antagonist, Queen of the vampires,” Double Trouble finished.

Catra’s eyes widened. “Are you telling me that they’re specifically looking for a hybrid actress to play the part of their new antagonist?”

“Bingo.”

“An antagonist that will be a thorn in the main character’s side?”

“You’re reading my mind, love.”

Catra's lips split into a venomous grin. Double Trouble chuckled at her, stowing their phone away. "And so you see why, Kitten," they sighed, "I rushed back here so urgently."

"How soon can we go?"

Double Trouble stood and reached for her towel. "As soon as you dry that furry ass of yours. I already booked your audition. It's in an hour."

Catra's heart skipped in her chest. Double Trouble strode out of her bathroom to give her space while she hurried to dry her fur and dress. The whole while, her mind was racing with thoughts. The loudest was always the same: *Am I good enough to get the part?*

The problem this time, though, was that it didn't matter. Catra needed to get this. Nothing else in her life had mattered as much as this suddenly did, at least, not until everything with... *her*, went wrong.

But this... fucking *this*, it was like the universe finally felt sorry for all of the shit it flung her way and was handing her the most golden opportunity.

If—no, *when*—Catra got this part, she would immensely enjoy playing the role of enemy and overall shit stirrer, doing nothing but antagonizing the show's beloved main character, Dominique.

Who, of course, was played by Adora.

Catra's fingers were twitching as she left with Double Trouble, but there was an eager bounce to her step. She hadn't felt this excited in years, and the confidence was nearly flowing through her veins.

Madame Razz was an anomaly in the film industry. No one knew where she came from, or how she really got started, only that she did and she was *phenomenal*. Every single thing touched by her

creativity was simply transformed into gold and success. So, when Madame Razz wanted something specific for a scene or a character, one didn't argue with her. Madame Razz knew what she was doing.

Adora had been surprised when Madame Razz announced that she specifically wanted a hybrid for the part of the vampire Queen. She didn't specify what type of hybrid, but of course Adora could only picture a certain magicat.

"Do you think we'll find the right hybrid?" she'd asked. She realized she sounded sceptical. The industry was still far behind in terms of inclusion, and this was evident even with Madame Razz. Hybrids simply weren't offered the same opportunities, which was a damn shame. Adora had met *many* hybrids with insane skill, who were not hired because they were too scaley or had tails or fur or too sharp claws.

"Of course, dear," Madame Razz drawled in that half-crazed, half-wise way. "I can feel it in the stars. *This* is what we need."

Who was Adora to argue with the great Razz? Following Razz's confident announcement, Adora couldn't stop thinking of Catra. Despite so much time having stretched between them, Adora's most vivid memories were still those of her days in Shadow's group home, training from the early hours of the morning with Catra at her side. It made her chest ache, as it always did.

Now, the ache was pure fire in her veins. Adora stood frozen in the doorway, her hand still curled around the handle, her eyes wide with shock and disbelief. Adora felt the sudden, intense urge to scream—in happiness, in frustration, in anger, in *longing*. She didn't, of course. She could barely even move. She felt paralysed by the rush of clashing emotions through her body, beating against her chest cavity, dripping off the tips of her ribs. If her heart could explode from the sheer force of her feelings, then she was already a dead woman walking.

"Adora?" Angella asked, her voice tinged with worry.

“Come in, deary,” Razz encouraged. “Come in and meet your enemy!”

Adora forced her muscles to unlock. Her eyes were still stuck on the person at the other side of the room, sitting at the end of the table—Catra. It was *Catra*.

“Adora, is everything alright?” Angella asked. “You look as if you’ve seen a ghost.”

Razz started to cackle, but Adora had no idea what amused her so much beyond the shock on Adora’s face. She swallowed thickly. Her mouth was incredibly dry and her body was still pulsing with adrenaline. But she moved forward, closed the door and took a seat at the other end of the table. Razz and Angella were to her left, and Catra... right before her.

“I’m fine,” she managed to croak, sounding decidedly *not* fine. But they had no way to know the thoughts swirling in her mind, the emotions crackling underneath her skin.

Catra looked good. She was calm, sitting comfortably and lightly drumming the tips of her claws on the table. Her hair was cut short, slicked back. She was wearing a dark maroon suit and a nearly feral look in her eyes. Despite the ten years between them, Adora could still tell that Catra was angry. Her tapping nails, the subtle tilt to her ears, the way her body was tensed like she would pounce at any second.

Adora recovered quickly from the rush of seeing her childhood friend again after so long, and she was reminded of *why* they hadn’t seen each other in so long. With that memory came her own anger, and she settled on banishing her expression of dumb awestruck to tentative annoyance.

“Right,” Angella said, interrupting her internal battle. “Adora, we would like you to meet Catra Cyra. She will be our Queen Cassandra.”

Adora's eyes widened slightly and she turned sharply to regard them. "It's already decided?"

Out of the corner of her eye, Adora spotted Catra's tail flick upwards just long enough to be noticed.

"I'm just that good," Catra drawled.

The sound of her voice sent a shock through Adora's heart. All in the span of a second she was already willing to discard her own hurt feelings and anger, and drop down at Catra's feet to beg for her forgiveness, for her attention. Catra's nails scratched against the metal table.

"She was breathtaking," Razz told her, eyes big and bright beyond her glasses. "You should have *seen* her, Adora. The talent! The depth!"

Adora knew that once Razz was this in love, there was absolutely no changing her mind. Not that Adora wanted to. She wasn't such an asshole. In fact, she was happy that Catra was doing well—clearly—and getting roles. She just... she never expected *this*.

"Shouldn't we do a chemistry read?" Adora decided to ask, because she had nothing else to say.

Catra's eyes landed on her, studied her. Adora felt the pull of her gaze, but she stubbornly refused to look at her again. Her emotions were so hot and cold—one second she was angry with Catra, and the next she wanted to draw her into her arms, never let her leave.

How could she still feel this way, after everything? After all these years?

"Not needed!" Razz cackled. "I could feel it the second you walked into this room, deary. Your chemistry is off the charts." She started rubbing her hands together and exchanged a look between them.

Could she tell? Did she somehow know that Adora and Catra knew each other? Had history? There was no way, and Adora knew—or at least used to—that Catra wasn't the sort of person to freely share her life story.

Adora swallowed and finally regarded Catra again. She was more relaxed in her seat, tail openly swaying behind her. Her smirk was smug, pleased, but her ears were slowly twitching backwards.

"Since we are skipping a few steps in the appointment of Catra, I thought it would be prudent to at the very least introduce the two of you before she meets the rest of the cast."

Razz's head bobbed enthusiastically at Angella's words. "Yes, yes! We begin filming so soon. So soon, dears. This is going to be magnificent. Catra will take Wolf Spring to new heights!"

Catra's smirk broadened, her ears pricked forward and Adora stared, wondering what she was thinking and feeling.

Razz rattled on about a few more things, and Angella asked Catra more questions, but Adora didn't hear them. She could only stare at Catra, could only wonder what this would mean for them. Without her consent, a tiny bud of hope settled in her chest.

After the discussion, Razz and Angella left to deal with whatever it was they did when they approached filming. The cast would start returning to the city if they'd left, and soon the studio would be bustling with activity again.

Catra didn't even look at her as she stood and left the room. Her previous calm was gone, and there was a deep furrow between her brows. Adora could see how frazzled her tail looked, knew what a warning that was. Still, she launched out of her chair and out the room, her heart shooting into her throat.

"Catra, wait!"

Catra paused and gazed over her shoulder. Her blue and yellow eyes were still so damn beautiful, even filled with that much hate.

Adora's nervousness doubled, but so did her annoyance. Who did Catra think she was, looking like Adora had been the one to hurt her, to shred their relationship to pieces? Adora's words dried up and she stared, heart pounding. Catra seemed to grow impatient with her.

"What, Adora?" she growled.

Adora sucked in a sharp breath at the sound of her name in Catra's voice. It had been so long, and still it sent a punch of longing right into her gut.

"I just, it's... it's been a while."

Catra's eyes narrowed. "I'm not here to play catch up."

The amount of bitterness in her voice was surprising. Adora narrowed her eyes. "Oh, of course not. Silly me, thinking maybe ten years was enough for you to get over yourself."

It was the exact wrong thing to say. Catra moved quickly, and then Adora was roughly shoved against the wall and claws dug into the brick right beside her head. Catra bared her sharp teeth and hissed.

"Get over myself?" Her voice was soft, but shaking. She looked barely controlled. "All the success has gone to your head, Princess."

Adora trembled. "Princess?"

Catra's smirk was cruel. "That's exactly what you are. Your life given to you through no effort of your own."

She pulled away. Adora wanted to continue fighting, but Catra's proximity had ruined her. Catra's smell was all around her now, and the heat of her had been *distracting*. Catra started walking away, but Adora just remained there against the wall, afraid that her shaking legs would not support her.

Catra walked away, she didn't look back, and all Adora could do was watch her until she disappeared beyond the double doors. Adora let out a breath, and then the tears pressed at her eyes. It took every breathing technique that she had to calm herself down and not sob right there on the floor.

Catra was shaking. As much as she kept trying, she just couldn't sheath her claws. The second Adora stepped into that room, her scent had smacked into Catra like a battering ram. Looking at pictures of Adora on the internet over the years had not prepared her for the full sight of her now, so grown up and strong. There was an easy smile on her face, a softness that Catra wished she was familiar with. Of course, as soon as Adora looked up and their eyes met, Adora froze.

Satisfaction had rocked down Catra's spine at that. Adora looked *devastated*, and it simply kept getting worse. Of course Adora would be upset to learn that Razz wanted to overlook their conventions in order to sign her on. Adora didn't want her to succeed, certainly not on *her* show. That made this whole thing even better.

When Catra had auditioned, she had channelled all of her own emotions into the scant lines given to her. It had been enough for them to immediately end auditions and claim her for the role. Catra wasn't used to this, and she was living for it. Razz looked at her like she was the shiniest diamond she had ever seen, and Catra honestly wanted to kiss the wrinkled woman right on the forehead.

Catra really liked the character she would be playing, too. Cassandra, Queen of the Vampires, a low-born vampire who had clawed her way to the top and ripped the Queen right from her throne to claim it for herself. It was the perfect role.

Double Trouble was overly pleased with themself, so Catra bought way too much alcohol and together they celebrated like they were still teenagers in high school. Catra vented a lot of her frustrations

and Double Trouble listened, swigging vodka right from the bottle and humming their acknowledgement of her slurred words.

“Darling, we need to get you laid,” Double Trouble told her, grabbing the bottle of wine from her hands before she could take the last sip.

Catra wasn’t really *that* drunk yet. It took a lot for her to even feel a buzz, which was why she had indulged and bought a lot. Double Trouble held their alcohol even better than she did, so they were still mostly put together besides a light dark flush over their cheeks. Still, their eyes were bright and alert.

Catra groaned and flopped down on her couch. “I do not need to get laid.”

“Yes you do.” Double Trouble set the bottle down. “You land a big role and the only thing you’re going on about is Adora. You’re still in love with her.”

Catra sobered up at those words. She sat up, arms coming up to hug herself. Her ears pressed flat to her head, but she didn’t try to dampen her tells. Double Trouble knew her too well anyway.

“That doesn’t matter,” she muttered quietly. “I’m going to play this part, annoy the hell out of her and remind her of her mistakes.”

“Why can’t you simply move on, Kitten?”

“It’s not that easy.”

“Sure it is. You just... get over it.”

Get over yourself.

Catra hissed, but she didn’t aim it at them. “Get over it?” she snarled. “She just... she left me. She stole from me, ruined me. How can I ever just move on?”

Double Trouble assumed a sheepish expression. “Sorry. I know how touchy this is for you. I just think it’s in my adult opinion that ten years is a *long* time to pine over someone you hate. Aren’t you tired of it?”

Catra’s claws dug into the couch beneath her. It wouldn’t damage, since it was made to withstand the abuse—exactly for moments like this.

“I’m exhausted,” she shot back. “I have no choice but to work with her now. I’m going to use this to my advantage, and once this puts me in the spotlight, I won’t need her. She’ll be beneath me.”

Double Trouble hummed under their breath. It was clear they wanted to continue arguing, and Catra knew it came from a place of concern. After all, she wouldn’t be where she was if not for them. She owed them her life—literally.

“Just think about this, DT,” she drawled, draping herself over their lap and lashing her tail. “I get to annoy the hell out of her every day on set. She’s not very good at hiding her reactions to *me* despite her acting skills.”

Double Trouble chuckled. “Devious little kitty.”

Catra’s grin was as sharp as Double Trouble’s. “Now give me my fucking wine back, bitch.”

A short struggle ensued, but Double Trouble gave up quickly and Catra was able to down another bottle before she stood and dragged herself to bed. She felt a blanket drape over her body, her boots pulled off and tossed to the floor, and then she listened to Double Trouble’s footsteps echoing in her apartment before they finally let themself out and she was left alone with her thoughts.

Alcohol in her system, bitterness in her veins, Catra clenched her teeth together. She grabbed one of her pillows and shredded it to

pieces between her claws. The tears fell silently, but they felt crushing.

So many years and... Adora still couldn't be happy for her? Couldn't congratulate her on her success? Support her?

"Asshole," Catra growled softly. She tossed the shredded pillow to the ground and ran her fingers through her hair. She hated how weak she felt, how much the hurt blossomed in her chest. It was easy before, to keep all of this away, to not feel it.

But seeing Adora again in person, hearing her voice and smelling her scent, had opened the floodgates. It was strange to think that she still felt so much for her, despite everything. But they needed to work together from now on, and maybe Double Trouble was right.

Maybe Catra should just get over it. Get over *her*.

Things started moving rapidly towards filming. Adora received a message from Glimmer saying that her and Bow were back in the city, but that they were too busy and would only see her again when they attended their first table read for the season. Adora had already been pouring over her script since the moment Razz had it sent over to her. She heard that right after Catra was cast, Razz had gone and heavily edited the script, much to Angella's exasperation. No one questioned Razz, though, and if she felt the script needed changing then the script needed changing.

Adora was surprised to see how prominent Cassandra would be this season. Their antagonists never usually took up this much screen time. They were usually in the background for the first handful of episodes until it was their turn to reveal their dastardly plan. But no, this time Cassandra was front and center. She was the opening scene.

As Adora went through the script, she was drawn in by the story and the clear conflict between her character, Dominique, and

Cassandra. It made her cheeks burn, and she really wondered if Razz had picked up on the actual tension between them. It was as if Razz had reached into their brains and plucked out all their angst, then tossed it between the pages. The most puzzling of all, was that Razz had left half a page blank towards the end of the script, for the last episode. This usually meant that she wasn't certain how the season would be received by viewers, and that she had something *big* planned but wanted to wait it out before committing.

This made Adora nervous. But more than that, so did the table read. Razz reworking the script pushed their schedule back, so they had to do the read earlier than planned to get things back on track.

It had been a couple weeks since being introduced to Catra again, since she snagged the role of Cassandra, and Adora felt just as much of a mess as she had the first time. Because of that, she barely slept the night before and accidentally dismissed her alarm. She was running late.

When Adora arrived on set she sprinted into the studio at full speed. She nearly spilled into the conference room, and she barely had time to flush when the entire casts' eyes landed on her curiously. She was gasping on big, hurried breaths and wiped a hand across her sweaty forehead.

"Adora!" Razz yelled, delighted. "I was worried you would miss the speech."

Adora offered everyone a nervous smile. "Sorry, guys. Slept through my alarm."

"Again," someone muttered. Everyone in the room chuckled.

"Adora." Angella placed a warm hand on her arm. "You are just in time. Please take your seat and then we can begin."

Adora nodded and headed over to her usual seat beside Glimmer and Bow. Her heart leapt into her throat when she realized Catra

had been seated directly beside her to her left, with Glimmer on her right and Bow beside her. To her surprise, Glimmer and Catra were laughing at something.

“Adora!” Bow exclaimed happily. “Thought you were having a heart attack with the way you busted in here.”

Adora’s cheeks flamed. “Sorry. I didn’t sleep well.”

“Still can’t manage your time well, huh?” Catra piped up, casual and almost... teasing?

Adora swallowed and stared at her. Catra’s face was actually relaxed. Her tail was still at her ankles and her ears were pricked forward. Nothing about her body language said that she was in any way uncomfortable, despite this being her first time meeting the entire cast. The room was bustling with hushed noises, Razz cackling about something one of the actors was telling her, Angella muttering as she scrolled on her pad to make sure her notes were in order. Catra’s ears twitched towards any sudden loud noise, but then swiveled forward again.

“Yeah,” Adora laughed nervously. “Bad habit.”

“Adora,” Glimmer cut in. “Why didn’t you ever tell us about Catra?” She leaned against Adora’s side to give Catra a big grin. “She’s hilarious.”

Adora squirmed in her seat.

“Yeah, Adora.” Catra’s tone was light, but Adora sensed a hidden layer of bitterness. “Why didn’t you tell them about me, your childhood friend?”

“It was a long time ago,” Adora explained. She could feel her face harden, saw the surprise flash over Glimmer’s face. Bow reached over to put a hand on her shoulder.

“Did something happen?” he asked her.

Adora gently shook his hand off and Glimmer sat up properly. Catra had her elbow on the table, chin propped up against her palm. Her tail gave a languid sweep behind her.

"No," Adora shot back too tersely. "Nothing happened."

Catra grinned, all teeth. "Nothing important," she added. "Adora got her role, was adopted by Mara. All good things for our favourite superhero."

Her voice was sickly sweet, but Adora knew better. Catra made a joke and sent Glimmer into a snort-attack, and Adora just sat back in her seat and glared down at her script.

Why was Catra doing this? Being so sweet? Just a few weeks ago Catra had been eager to claw her head off. Was she trying to make amends *now*? Was she pretending?

Once again, that flame of hope flickered. Adora needed to stamp it out quickly before it turned into a blazing inferno.

Angella's clapping hands silenced conversations and brought all eyes to her. "Welcome back, everyone," she started. "Madame Razz and I would like to thank you for your hard work and dedication on season 4. Our ratings have gone up again. This show would not be what it is without every hand that helps mould it."

"Especially mine!" Razz cut in with a pleased grin. The cast all laughed.

"Yes, yes," Angella sighed, rolling her eyes. "After casting of Cassandra," she pointed at Catra, and more curious gazes swept her way, "Madame Razz had to rework the script nearly entirely. We have casted a few more minor roles. I would like to introduce Catra." Catra gave a little wave to the room. "She will be joining the team as our best antagonist yet. Please work well with her. Now, you will all have noticed the blank space at the end of the script." Angella took a step backwards and Razz filled the spot. She adjusted her glasses to study the room.

"Often, creativity is like water." A very low chuckle passed through the room, people sharing glances. "Sometimes I will be swimming in a very tiny lake, and then BAM! I realize that there is an underwater cavern, and I *must* explore it. Catra's addition will set Wolf Spring to new heights. I had no choice but to change the script. Because of all of this, I have a few little noodle ideas simmering away. I will bake them when the time comes, but for now they are in the freezer. Please have patience with me, and I hope we all enjoy this story we have been crafting for the last few years."

Despite how bizarre she could be, there was no doubt that the entire crew, from management to cast to cleaners, adored the hell out of Razz. She was like family to them, and she treated them that way. That was the biggest reason people didn't begrudge her the strange or sometimes sudden changes to story or set. Razz gave them her unyielding love, so everyone gave her their loyalty and their talent. It was such a beautiful give and take, and Adora felt grateful to be part of this.

Angella introduced a few of the new side characters, and listed the names of the batch of new extras who would be sprinkled in the background. Razz didn't like to leave anyone out, not for anything.

The only other major role was Cassandra's sidekick, Theo, who would be played by a woman named Scorpia. She blushed furiously when introduced and mumbled a host of thank yous when everyone clapped for her. She looked new to the industry, but Razz knew what she was doing, and if Scorpia was a fresh-faced actor, then being in this agency was the best possible start for her.

After all of the introductions, Razz accepted a few questions and refused to answer any of those asking about the blank page. When all of that was done and the cast settled, they had to start the reading.

They would do a reading of episode 1 first, before shooting for it. Adora had the episode memorized by now, of course, but this would be the first time hearing Catra say her lines.

The episode—and the season—started in a bar. It was described as being run-down and seedy, the sort of bar where illegal magical trades were often made. Dominique was there to wallow in the knowledge she had received during season 4, about her origin and heritage. She was just looking for a drink and some clarity. Cassandra was there for other reasons, but Cassandra noticed who she was immediately by scent alone.

Catra had been oddly friendly before, but when it came time for them to speak their lines, she slipped into her role perfectly. Adora was so taken aback that she fumbled many times and they had to start over. Catra's body language changed as well. As Cassandra threatened and snarked at her, so did Catra. Adora started to get the sense that this was less Cassandra calling Dominique an idiot, and Catra calling *her* that.

Catra's tail lashed behind her, thwapping against the back of her chair. Her ears flicked downwards sharply as she snarled her next lines, and Adora could only stare at her with wide eyes and a thundering heart. Catra's nose twitched and she glanced away, sighing.

"You have no idea, do you?" Catra said to her, the venom no longer dripping from her voice, but still laced with it. "Such an ignorant puppy."

Adora stared at the side of Catra's face. She had to remember they were acting. She needed to play the part. Right now, she wasn't Adora Gray, she was Dominique. She was the alpha werewolf, the strongest of her kind. She was a werewolf struggling with figuring out where she came from and why she was born at all.

"No idea about what?" Adora snapped back, letting all of her real frustration leak into Dominique's lines. "Who the hell are you,

anyway?”

Catra turned bodily to face her, then. She was smirking, one fang laced over her bottom lip. This wasn’t needed in the table read, but she still leaned forward and grabbed Adora’s chin. Her claws were out, and she dragged the sharp point of her thumb across Adora’s cheek.

“I’m your nightmare,” Catra purred darkly, her eyes flashing with wild delight. “You can call me Cassandra.”

“Cassandra,” Adora repeated, not intending for her voice to sound so breathless. She knew her face was dark red. Dominique was supposed to be annoyed and cocky, not... this. Not flustered and devastated.

Catra dropped her chin, pulling back. She let out an attractive, crazed laugh. “Remember my name, Pup,” she drawled. “For when you’re bowing down before me.”

The scene ended there after a bar fight broke out and Cassandra slipped away without Dominique even seeing. As soon as it was over, Catra relaxed in her seat and seemed to become someone else again. Everyone at the table clapped and Razz made a very loud noise of excitement.

“That was phenomenal!” Razz cried out. “Catra, Adora, phenomenal! Please do the scene exactly like that when we film! Oh, this was so much better. I knew I could trust both of you to go on your feelings.”

Adora could feel Bow’s eyes on her, a question in them. Had others sensed that most of that hadn’t just been acting? Hadn’t been pretend?

Catra was drinking in the praise and the attention. For a second, Adora thought she could hear a low rumbling, but it disappeared too quickly.

The table read for the episode continued, but Cassandra and Dominique didn’t have another scene together until the next episode. Adora was still out of sorts, kept mixing up her lines, and the more she fell apart the more concerned Bow seemed to be. Glimmer didn’t really notice, and she kept giving Catra heart eyes.

As soon as the table read was over, Adora was up and out of her seat. She grabbed Bow by the hand and tugged him with.

“Adora?”

“We need to talk,” she told him. “I need to talk about this or I’m going to explode.”

She glanced over her shoulder and saw Catra smirking at her. Despite the way the look was clearly *mocking*, she couldn’t stop her heart from giving an uneven thump.

“Fuck,” she mumbled under her breath.

“Adora, what’s going on?”

“I’m going to lose my mind.”

She had no idea how true that statement really was.

Chapter End Notes

> Hi all! Thank you so much for reading, and welcome to my celeb AU. I've been planning a whole ton about this fic, and I've been so damn excited to share it. So we're finally here, with this first chapter out in the wind. Please let me know what you think. Comments mean the world to me, as well as every kudos, and I hope all of you are as excited and in love with this story as I am. I have SO much planned, and a lot of extra things that I want to include in this fic. Again, thank you for reading! My tumblr is this-writer-d if you'd like to say hi or scream about this fic

Take One, So There's a Leak on Set

Chapter Notes

I have so far divided this fic into three "takes". They denote the arcs, basically. I thought it's cooler than using act or arc lol. So, Take One will span the filming of season 5. Take Two will be the break after filming, when the season airs. Take Three will bring everyone back to begin filming for season 6. I'm just going to give another reminder that I have NO clue what I'm doing and how filming works and no I don't take criticism lol. I'm just making it up as I go to suit the plot.

Thank you to everyone that has read, commented and left a kudos! I'm so happy with the interaction I've gotten so far. But also! You're very welcome to come and scream at my tumblr this-writer-d. I promise I will be very happy to get a message. I crave that validation yo lol.

Enjoy the chapter!!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

“Wow, so you really have no idea what happened?”

Adora tipped her head back to rest against the trailer behind her, letting out a deep sigh. “No. We never got back into contact after I left. I guess, I was just hurt, you know?”

Bow gently bumped their shoulders. “I would be too. Have you thought about trying to talk to her about it?”

Adora’s brows drew together. “I don’t think that’s really an option.”

“She seems pretty pliable to me.”

At that, Adora wanted to laugh until her belly ached. She would have believed that too, if her first meeting with Catra had been there at the reading table. But no, she knew the truth. That Catra

had sunk her claws into the brick wall beside her head. That Catra had bared her fangs and growled low in her chest. There was no doubt that Catra still absolutely hated her guts, and if she was anything like she had been at sixteen, then she was incredibly stubborn still, too.

"I'll try," she lied, shrugging.

Bow was trying to be an understanding ear, but he was struggling to reconcile the Catra she had described and the one he had met. Apparently she was *delightful*. Adora knew for a fact that if anyone called Catra delightful to her face, she would claw their lips off.

Talking about it had helped a little. The anxiety wasn't so bad in her chest, and it was easy to resolve to stand strong in the force of Catra's hatred. It hurt. It hurt so fucking bad, but she would let it all roll off her back as if it didn't. Catra didn't know, and she didn't need to. If she was determined to still act like a child after so many years, then so be it.

Adora could be petty too.

Laughter caught her attention, and Adora lifted her face to see Glimmer and Catra approaching them. Catra was laughing—genuinely laughing—and the sight of her easy expression made the resolve Adora had built up dissolve into nothing.

"Hey Adora," Catra greeted with a little smirk once they paused by them. "Hope we're not interrupting."

Her tone was overly flirtatious, but Adora knew why she was doing it. The others wouldn't understand, either. They probably wouldn't even notice.

"No," Adora answered. "We're done."

Catra's tail lashed behind her and Adora was suddenly assaulted with the memory of when they had been just little kids, when Catra had joined Shadow's home for the first time and Adora

learnt the hard way *not* to grab a magicat's tail. The memory made emotion swell in her throat, and Adora nervously rubbed the back of her neck. Catra was watching her with a piercing stare, and she seemed to notice the shift in Adora's mood.

"Catra, can we talk?"

Catra opened her mouth in a half snarl, and Adora was sure she was going to brutally reject her request.

"Catch up!" Bow interrupted with a big grin. "Don't let us bother you two. We're heading over to make-up. Take your time." He gave Adora a pat on the back and Catra a wink, then grabbed Glimmer and steered her away.

Adora was both grateful and terrified. Catra wasn't leaving, but her easy expression had disappeared. Her body was tense now, fur a little fluffed up at her tail and upper arms, and her ears were steadily twitching downwards. Adora worried that if she spoke, Catra would spook and run.

"I already told you I'm not here to catch up."

"Catra..." Adora wrung her hands together and took in a deep breath. "Look, I'm really happy that you got this role."

Catra's eyes narrowed. "Oh, you are?" Her tone was snide.

"But we have to work together now," she barrelled on. "So can we maybe put this away, whatever this is between us and just act civil?"

Those were apparently the exact wrong words to use. Catra's tail fully fluffed up and Adora saw the sharp edges of her claws before she surged forward. Adora stepped back quickly until she was pressed up against the trailer. But Catra didn't touch her. She certainly did get into her personal space, and she looked absolutely livid. Like this, her one blue eye was brighter than Adora had ever seen it.

She's still so beautiful, Adora mused to herself.

"*Whatever this is between us?*" Catra snarled. "I don't even know why I expected you to care at all. I'm surprised you aren't banging down Razz's door to demand they replace me. You hate it, don't you? Having to work with me now. Seeing me here, in *your* space. Well, news flash, *Adora*, this world is big enough for both of us." Her chest heaved harshly with the outburst, and Adora was so taken aback that she was speechless. "So just stay away from me and we'll be fine, got it? I bite."

She punctuated that last bit by baring her sharp teeth, and then she was gone. Turning and walking off towards make-up, where the others had gone to. Adora stared after her, again. She felt like this would be an ongoing thing, Catra scrambling her brain and just, walking off like it was nothing.

Why did Catra think she didn't want her here? Of course she was happy. She only ever wanted to see Catra succeed in life, especially with her own aspirations. It all made absolutely no sense, and it just served to make Adora's frustration mount. Clearly she would never find out exactly what she had done to make Catra so angry, and she respected herself too much to keep trying. She needed to maintain her resolve, to not let Catra's laugh or smile or beautiful eyes make her think it was safe to try again.

Catra was like a rose. Beautiful, but dangerous. And unlike a scorned human friend, Catra actually had claws.

Catra had an absolute blast with filming. Besides needing a wig for the long hair and contacts to give her red eyes, she didn't spend hours in make-up like the others did, and especially Adora. Any time she had a scene where she had to half-shift, Adora had to spend hours getting fake fur pasted on her. Catra thought it was hilarious.

During their scenes, Catra let loose. She antagonized way more than the script called for, but it was so amusing the way Adora reacted to it. Catra could tell the difference between acted lines and Adora's actual feelings. Knowing Adora was being affected by this, was frustrated, made Catra smirk in satisfaction every time a scene ended. The others congratulated her on another day of successful filming, some of them asking how she did it so well, and she would just smile and shrug.

You hate her, she would think. *You hate her with the force of a burning sun for the way she tore your heart to shreds.*

Catra was being unreasonable. She knew this, and she didn't care. Sometimes she would get comfortable, would enjoy herself, and she would consider just doing as Double Trouble kept demanding. *Getting over it*. But it always just took one small thing. She would hear Adora laughing, or see her smiling across set, and it would made Catra's chest tighten. She would, for just a brief moment, flash back to their childhood, to a time where Adora had been her champion. But then she would remember what came next, what Adora did, and how she had left without so much as a goodbye. Catra had been forced to live through all of the trauma herself, and knowing that Adora never came back for her, or tried to contact her, made the anger and resentment just seep back in.

Catra didn't actually want to be fighting all the time. Most times, it wasn't even necessary. Sometimes all it took was just ignoring Adora flat to get under her skin. It was also a little difficult, and she would never admit this, to see the occasional hurt flash across her eyes. Why was Adora hurt, if she couldn't have been bothered to begin with?

Catra always pushed her own guilt and shame down, and instead tugged her anger back onto its feet and dusted its collar off. Double Trouble always accused her of having a soft heart, and she would always hiss and swipe at them when they did. They were right, of course.

"Cut!" Razz called, and Catra let out a deep groan of frustration.

“Sorry, sorry!” Adora called out. She looked about as exhausted as Catra felt, and she pressed her thumbs into her eyes because she couldn’t rub her face, with all the make-up on.

Razz came over to them, frowning contemplatively. They had been at this take for hours now and it was already nearing 1am. They all needed to still sleep to be back on set at 6, and Adora was keeping them because she kept fucking up. Catra didn’t know what was going on with her, but she needed to figure her shit out.

“Adora,” Madame Razz started gently. “Do it just like we discussed, yes?”

Adora’s shoulders dropped ever so slightly. “I know. I just... I’m sorry, I’ll try harder. I’ll get it right.”

Razz nodded and went back over to her seat. She looked bright and alert, and Catra had learned over the past couple of weeks that it was likely she hardly slept at all.

Adora stared at her palms and flexed her fingers. She looked a bit dumb so caked up, but Catra knew that their effects crew would make her look deadly when they went into editing. Catra had watched all of the previous seasons—much to Double Trouble’s delight.

Adora’s shoulders lifted and dropped, and it was apparent that she was counting her breaths. Catra frowned, recognizing the technique to deal with anxiety. She didn’t like that she noticed this, because now she couldn’t ignore it. Sighing in annoyance, Catra stalked over to her and tugged her hand down with her tail. She pulled her tail away quickly.

“Why is this so difficult for you?”

Blue eyes narrowed at her. “Why do you care?”

Catra wanted to slap her upside the head. “I’m fucking tired, Adora. We all are. If you’re not going to get this scene right, then let’s just go home and try again tomorrow.”

Adora's jaw set. "No. If we don't finish this today, that pushes the schedule back."

Catra groaned and resisted the urge to rip her wig off. She was covered in sweat and absolutely done. "You're hesitating," she spat. "You're not being angry and aggressive enough."

"I don't..." Adora curled into herself. "I just feel uncomfortable with this scene."

Catra laughed. "What, like you're not enjoying slamming me into the wall?"

The crew weren't even really talking, they were so exhausted. Razz was studying them quietly, but no one was rushing them to finish their conversation and get back to their marks. Adora studied her carefully, suspiciously. Catra felt herself flush, but was grateful that her fur hid it.

"No matter what's happened between us, or how much we don't like each other, the thought of hurting you doesn't bring me pleasure, Catra."

The flush burned brighter. Her treacherously soft heart gave a painful throb against her ribs, and Catra felt like for a scary second that she would crack. She would drop this furious facade and forgive Adora for everything. The second passed, and Catra didn't allow the feelings to pass over her face.

"You're missing out, Princess," she said instead, smirking. "It's loads of fun. Takes the steam off."

Adora sighed in mounting frustration. "Yeah, I noticed."

"Look." Catra's tail lashed. "I don't need to teach you how to act. You know how to do this. Just, reach deep inside and pull on anything that's still festering in there. Dominique is angry enough to bite Cass's head off. You need to channel that, Adora. Every take so far you've looked like you might throw up every time you land."

Conflict flashed over Adora's face, but she gave a small nod and they were called to return to their marks. Adora had to leap down from what was supposed to be a roof, so she was still hooked up to the safety gear. Catra watched her get in place and flashed a smirk, which just made her expression darker.

There we go, she thought*, get angry, Adora. I want to go home and sleep*.

"Action!"

Adora leapt from the roof with an animal growl that was pretty damn convincing, and then she landed and bared her fake-fanged teeth and surged forward. Catra blinked, taken aback suddenly by the transformation of Adora's entire expression and aura. Her hesitance and reluctance from before were completely gone. Catra was slammed into the padded wall, and the gasp of a breath she let out was genuine.

"Got you," Adora snarled, and then she smirked deviously.

Catra's heart thumped. There was a tug between her legs, and her cheeks blossomed to life again.

The rest of the scene continued as normal, with them fighting and nearly demolishing the room around them. When Razz called for the end of the scene, the entire crew let out noises of relief. Catra rolled off of Adora and stared up at the bright lights pouring down on them, breathing haggardly.

It was the exhaustion. It was from doing a physically taxing scene —Catra did all of her own stunts and fighting scenes, as Adora did. The fire in her lower belly was *not*... that. There was no way that Catra was painfully turned on because of Adora throwing her around during a fucking scene.

Adora sat up with a groan and ran her fingers through her short hair. She peered over at her. "Catra."

Catra's brows furrowed but she refused to look at her.

"Thank you," Adora finished. "You didn't have to help me. You didn't owe me that. I appreciate it."

Throb.

Catra stood and dusted her fancy outfit off, then started off. "Whatever," she threw over her shoulder. Adora didn't say anything, or follow closely after, and Catra managed to clean up and get into her car and leave set without another incident. Her tired mind was fixated on their interactions, though, and when Catra collapsed into bed after a very quick shower, the last thing she thought of was Adora's blue eyes and the curve of her frown.

Through the years in Shadow's home, kids always came and went. No one ever stayed there as long as Adora, and then later on, Catra. But Catra knew what a thin line she was treading. The only reason she ever stayed around was because of Adora. *For* Adora.

"I only tolerate your failure to ensure Adora performs as she must," Shadow growled at her, when she was only eight years old. "Don't think I won't dispose of you the moment she grows bored with you."

Adora hadn't been there. It was after an audition, where Catra had burst into tears after she messed up a line and the judges laughed at her. She hated attention. She hated auditions and dancing and singing. She hated hated hated it. The only thing she didn't hate was Adora. But Adora wasn't there.

Shadow didn't say anything as she drove them home, but Catra continued to quietly sob in the back seat. When they arrived at the house, Catra didn't even wait for the car to come to a full stop before she was out and darting for her shared room with Adora. She wasn't there, but that was okay. The room smelt like her. Like *home* and safety. Catra snatched Adora's blanket and crawled underneath her bed, cocooned in the warmth of her scent and the comfort of being hidden from the world that only ever hurt her.

Adora eventually returned from wherever it was she had been, and she found Catra underneath her bed. She reached under for her, but Catra hissed and swiped at her out of reflex. She didn't *want* Adora to leave, but her senses were running on overdrive and her instincts were screaming at her to *fight*.

"Catra," Adora called out softly. "Can I come under with you, then?"

Catra didn't respond to that, so Adora took that as the confirmation that it was. Even though she was a little bigger, Adora got underneath her bed and crawled over until they were pressed together. She didn't say anything, or reach out to her. Catra inhaled and her nerves calmed with Adora's scent washing over her, right from the source. Adora was patient.

Eventually, Catra lifted the edge of the blanket and allowed Adora in with her. Only then did Adora reach for her, and Catra sank into the safety of her arms. She sobbed against Adora's new superhero shirt, but she didn't seem to care. She just petted Catra's hair and kissed her forehead and that was the day that Catra realized, at just eight years old, that she probably loved Adora.

Catra woke up to the sound of her phone ringing. She ignored it, turned onto her other side and tried to go back to sleep, but her phone started up again right after the call ended. It would be a continuous hour of this until Catra actually realized it wasn't just DT or her alarm.

Catra blinked at her phone when she finally grabbed for it.

32 missed calls.

18 messages.

65 emails.

All in the last 6 hours. They were mostly numbers and email addresses that she didn't recognize, but a few of them she did.

They were other agencies, some journalists. Catra was highly confused as she went through her emails, and then she realized.

Someone had leaked that she would be playing Cassandra. She knew Razz had planned on announcing it when they were halfway through filming, once they had enough promo material. She was keeping Catra secret, like her trump card. But here it was, an entire article on Etheria Daily sharing every single detail of Catra's acting career. It was jarring. There were even some sneaky backstage shots, most of them in make-up or walking across set, but there was one that made Catra's tail bush up.

It was when she'd had Adora backed up against the trailer and got up in her face. It was a very scandalous picture, without the context. The media was running wild with it already, despite having no clue who Catra Cyra was.

Her phone rang again, and this time she answered it immediately.

"Will the flames of envy burn down the set of Wolf Spring before season 5 has a chance to shine?" Double Trouble drawled over the call.

Catra's ears pressed to her head. "What the *fuck*, DT."

They let out a delighted laugh. "Why, I thought you always wanted this, Kitten. The second someone leaked your details, the whole of Etheria had a collective frothing at the mouth. Some of these articles are rather ridiculous, but you must admit that shot of you and Adora facing off is rather... scandalous."

Catra blinked. There was a bird sitting on her windowsill, chirping loudly and bouncing around. She could see its little silhouette through her curtain.

"I... made news?"

"You made the news, kitty cat. Front and centre. They've managed to pull every awful film and commercial you've ever been in."

Her heart felt like it would jump right out of her chest. There was the sting of nerves in her belly, but other than that joy coursed through her entire body. *This* is what she always wanted. She wondered if Adora had already seen this, if she knew that this picture of them was making the front page of every magazine and gossip site in Etheria.

She couldn't wait to find out.

Trouble in Wolf Spring?

Hot Tempers or Old Enemies?

Who is Catra Cyra, and Why Can't Adora Gray Stand Her?

Catra Cyra, Unknown Actress Rising into Fame

Adora Gray Jealous of New Co-Star Catra Cyra, or Something Else…?

The tabloids weren't anything new. Adora had been dealing with this since she landed the role of She-Ra, even in the very first film. But this time it somehow felt different, because every headline was either pitting her and Catra against each other, or insinuating they were *together*. It was a little sad and a little funny, how almost close they were.

Mara called her up early in the morning, obviously having seen the media frenzy. News of Catra had broken the night before, someone on set leaking information. They either leaked it themselves, or were paid off. It happened, but Adora knew Razz was going to be one of two things—delighted or enraged. It all depended on her mood, really, and how the news was being taken by the media and fans.

"Why are these articles implying you and your co-star are at each other's throats?" Mara asked her by way of greeting.

“Hi Mara, it’s so nice to hear from you again. Oh, me? I’m doing well, thank you for asking.”

Mara laughed. “Adora.”

She groaned out a sigh. “The tabloids aren’t exactly wrong.”

“What’s going on? Do you need to talk about it?”

Adora spread out flat on her bed and stared up at her ceiling. She did want to talk about it, but everything still felt too full in her chest. She worried that if she started, she wouldn’t be able to stop and like a punctured balloon she would simply deflate into nothing.

“Not right now,” she answered. “I just need to focus on work. Once the season is out I can take a little break and figure it out.”

“You should fly down once filming is over,” Mara told her. “Swifty misses you, and so do I.”

Adora couldn’t help smiling despite her dark mood. “That actually sounds amazing. I think I need a week in the tropics after all of this.”

“You know, I’m burning with curiosity.”

“You can just read the gossip mags.”

“But they all tell such different stories.”

Adora laughed. “Then try to piece the actual truth together.”

Mara went silent for a moment, then let out another laugh. “Challenge accepted.”

They switched topics to other things and caught up, and when the dark grey of her room turned orange with the morning sun, Adora ended the call and got ready for work. When she arrived on set,

everyone looked nervous. One of the new PA's ran up to her with a coffee and handed it over, smiling nervously.

"Madame Razz requested to see you in her office as soon as you arrive."

Adora took the coffee with a nod. "Thank you. I'll head over now."

Madame Razz was the least frightening person Adora had ever met, and she had met *many* being in the business as she was. There were always plenty of actors or producers who thought they were above it all, and who thought they were intimidating enough. Considering her dark background, it took a lot to actually intimidate Adora. So, as she walked through the studio to Razz's office, she wasn't frightened in the least, but she was nervous. She felt as though someone had let loose a whole pack of needles in her stomach, and with every step she took they punctured her soft insides.

Adora found Razz's door open as she approached, and when she filled the doorway Razz blinked up at her from her desk.

"Come in, dear!" Razz told her. "Close the door behind you, please."

Adora's eyes flicked to Catra sitting in one of the chairs across from Razz, and her heart gave an unsteady thump. She felt shaky as she closed the door and went to take the other seat, right beside her. Catra didn't say anything to her, or even look her way. Her tail was lightly swaying where it hung off the edge of the chair, and Adora burned to know what was going on in her head. Surely, she had heard about the leak.

"Alright, thank you for joining me," Madame Razz started. "Angella will be with us shortly. I assume you both know why I've asked for you. We have a leak on set."

Adora shifted in her seat. "Any ideas who?"

Razz shook her head. “While it is unfortunate, these things do happen. We do not know who. The important thing is to carry on the momentum. That is why I am asking a favour of you both.”

Catra’s ear gave a flick, but she still said nothing. Adora wanted to ask, but the door opened and Angella entered, looking a bit ruffled. She went to stand behind Razz and set her ipad down on the desk, letting out a tired sigh.

“Good morning, ladies,” Angella greeted them. “I was accosted by the paparazzi on my own front lawn. I apologize for being late.”

Razz cackled like that was the most amusing thing she had ever heard in her life. “All eyes are on us now!”

While Razz was overflowing with delight, Angella look disgruntled. “Adora, Catra. We have attempted to redirect the plotline of the gossip headlines, but I’m afraid there is nothing we can do. As Madame Razz said, we suddenly have all eyes in Etheria. Razz, how do you want us to handle this PR nightmare?”

“We don’t,” Razz shrugged. They all stared at her. “Angella, sit down, dear. You hover like a nervous bee. It gives me gas.”

Angella went to sit down at the nearby couch, frowning.

“My plan was to create overwhelming hype for this new season by releasing a whole bunch of promotional stuff with Catra in it,” Razz started. Her eyes blinked behind her glasses. “But that plan has been kicked right off the table.”

Guilt started to build in Adora’s chest. Maybe if she and Catra hadn’t fought, the leak wouldn’t have had anything to sell to the paparazzi. “Razz, I’m so—”

“For what?” Catra cut her off, nearly snarling. “It’s not our damn fault someone on this set betrayed us.”

“Exactly!” Razz agreed, clapping her hands. “In fact, this is even better!”

“Razz,” Angella hurried, sitting so far on the edge of the couch that she looked as if she was half a second away from falling right off. “Are you sure you want us to feed into these gossip stories?”

Razz bobbed her head enthusiastically. “Nothing draws curiosity quite like on-set drama, yes?” Her large eyes levelled with Adora. “I’ve heard the rumours that the two of you don’t get along,” she said. Adora flushed in shame and Catra’s ears pinned back. She was clearly surprised. Razz was often pretty air-headed, and a lot of people assumed she wasn’t altogether there. But she was exceptionally sharp, and she knew every single thing that went on in her studio. “I don’t expect either of you to share your personal thoughts or feelings, but I do want to ask if you can try your hardest to appear at least friendly when in public?”

Catra scoffed. “You want us to be *friendly*? I thought you were going to ask us to fight more.”

“Oh, never,” Razz gasped. “You’re both welcome to argue in your free time. At least try to act like you like each other just a little bit.” She held her fingers out in a pinching motion, a tiny bit of space between them. “Like this.”

Angella sighed in exasperation. “We have a joint shoot scheduled for the both of you soon, after filming for episode 7. That’s why Razz is asking.”

Adora finally built the nerve to look at Catra, and she was surprised to see her looking back nervously. “Of course,” she finally said. “I can be amicable, if Catra will.”

Catra rolled her eyes. “We’re actors. Pretending is our thing.”

“Fantastic!” Razz’s chair squeaked loudly. “With filming for episode 5 wrapped up, we need to head out for episode 6.”

Adora’s head whipped around to stare at Razz. “Wait, what?”

Angella stood to grab her ipad and tapped around on its screen. “The schedule has shifted,” she answered absently. “We were

going to announce it to the whole crew a little later. We will be filming on location for episode 6. We leave tomorrow at 3am."

After that, they were relieved and left Razz's office together. They were told to take the rest of the day off to relax before travelling tomorrow.

"She can just do that?" Catra asked her.

Adora was so surprised to hear Catra ask her a normal question in a regular tone of voice that she didn't even register the question until Catra quirked a brow at her, waiting.

"Uh, what?"

Catra rolled her eyes. "Just change the schedule like that. We were supposed to film episode 6 on set, not location. This is pretty short notice."

Adora blew out a long breath. "Oh, yeah she totally can do that. I've been here long enough that it doesn't really surprise me anymore. Whatever Razz has planned, it's going to be awesome." She couldn't help the bright smile on her face, even as Catra studied her with suspicious eyes.

This was the friendliest they had been to each other in *weeks*. Scratch that, in *years*.

"Hey, uh," Adora started. She felt her cheeks warm again. "The attention might get intense from here. If you need any help or anything, you can always contact me."

Catra let out a laugh that made Adora's chest burn. "Oh please, I can handle some nosey paparazzi. I can pretend to be friends with you, Adora, but that doesn't mean I actually like you."

Adora's lips pressed together. "Sure."

Her expression was mild this time, but Catra still narrowed her eyes at her like she was considering how her face would look with

a few extra claw marks. Adora saw the way her eyes lingered at her jaw, where she had her most notable claw scars from when Catra had scratched her by accident when they first met. Many people had asked Adora why she didn't just get them fixed, but she told them the same thing every time. It was important to her, something she would never erase from her skin or her heart.

"I'm going to leave now," Catra told her.

Adora supposed that was the closest thing to a goodbye she would get. Catra walked off and Adora watched her, for probably way longer than was necessary. There was a tinge of worry in her chest, but she knew Catra could handle herself.

If anything, Adora needed to worry for the poor souls brave enough to stalk and photograph a constantly pissed off magicat.

"Adora!" Glimmer wailed right into her ear. "We're going to Plumeria tomorrow! I'm tired, I don't want to travel."

She was leaning into Bow, who looked about as done with this as Adora did. "You know the drill, Glim."

Glimmer groaned. "I swear, it's like Razz has some supernatural sense about these things. Why Plumeria suddenly? Why the change in location? Let's hope she doesn't change the script again."

Adora was too distracted thinking about Catra to reply.

Chapter End Notes

> Thank you so much for reading! Comments are always so, so appreciated. Also! I want some juicy drama to happen with media/paparazzi/fans so if any of you have some ideas for things that can happen, please drop them in the comments. I will also soon be asking for help with questions to ask Catra and Adora when they do interviews, so if you have any ideas for those you're welcome to share them too!

Take One, Celebrity Status

This was a little bit insane, if Catra was being honest. Of course, she knew that this sort of thing came with the territory. Who became surprised by becoming known when entering the celebrity sphere of Etheria?

Catra had been lucky to have just over 100 twitter followers, but now since the leak she was steadily climbing to over 1000. So, it was a little bit insane.

Something twisted bitterly in her chest despite the triumphant smirk constantly on the cusp of breaking out. She kept telling herself that she *earned* this, but it still felt like a cop out. The season hadn't aired yet. They hadn't released any of the promotional material yet. Hell, they hadn't even shot most of the promo yet. How were people following her because of *her*, if they hadn't even seen her yet?

Catra tried to stamp out the feeling, but it was vicious as it took hold of her. She wasn't gaining recognition as *Catra Cyra*, but simply because of what she was being attached to. Wolf Spring was huge. Catra had always known this. They shot in different, beautiful locations all over the world. Many actors had started their massive careers thanks to Wolf Spring, and many already known faces had guest-starred. It was the sort of show that had droves and droves of rabid, obsessed fans. The sheer amount of fan content created for this show was absolutely wild.

No, Catra never had an awkward phase where she followed a few Wolf Spring fanartists, specifically to see the various ways they drew Adora's abs. That would be ridiculous (she did).

It was exhausting feeling like this, and Catra hated it. She was already starting to resent the show, but she was aware that it was all just her own issues.

The next day was Thursday, and when Catra woke at 2am to shower and get her bags in Double Trouble's convertible, she was in a foul mood.

Double Trouble smartly didn't comment after she slammed the passenger door shut and buckled her seatbelt.

"Are you excited for your first time travelling?" they asked her carefully instead, peering at her curiously with a perfectly manicured brow lifted.

Catra let out a soft growl, which was answer enough. Double Trouble simply started the car and took them to the airport. Traffic was non-existent this early, so they made it there in record time—but so had *everyone else.* After dropping their luggage off and their tickets checked, they made it to the waiting area where they would be boarding. It was packed with people, and Catra assumed Razz had booked the entire flight for their whole crew.

"I'm parched," Double Trouble said, "I'm going to buy a beverage." Their slitted eyes flicked over to the one end of the stack of seats, and Catra knew who they were looking at. "Don't hiss too hard," the warned airily, and then they left, their heels clacking loudly as they went to peruse the various pop-up shops. Catra sighed.

She knew Adora was looking at her. She willed herself not to look back, to act like she didn't even know she was there. It took her only 3 seconds to betray herself, and then she was lifting her head, and their eyes locked and Catra's heart clenched.

Adora's expression was a little severe. There was a crease between her brows and she looked as though she was permanently chewing the corner of her lip. Even from across the seats, Catra could pick up her scent easily. It was familiar and foreign all at once, a strange body spray mingled in with the smell that was just *Adora*. The scent betrayed her too, and it made her muscles relax ever so slightly. Her fur was still bristling, but that she couldn't really help.

More than anything, Catra wanted to go over there and sit with her. She wanted to have Adora back, *her* Adora who had defended her and maybe even loved her. Not this, the Adora that looked at her with thinly veiled anger but undisguised hurt. As if *Adora* was the one hurt. The longing made Catra angry, and when she was angry, she was petty.

Instead of giving in to her juvenile urges, she swivelled and went to the entire other side, as far from Adora as she could go, and plopped down next to Scorpia. She was a little annoying, but alright. Far better than Adora's company.

"Catra!" she greeted, beaming. "Are you excited? I'm super excited. Oh man, shooting in Plumeria? I've never been there before!"

"It's beautiful," a new voice interrupted, and Catra's ear twitched. She picked up the flowery scent before Perfuma settled down in the seat to Scorpia's other side. "I grew up there."

Scorpia gasped. "Tell me all about it!"

Catra was infinitely grateful for Perfuma's interruption, because she didn't need to answer the question or even indulge in the conversation. Scorpia was completely enraptured as Perfuma told her stories of her childhood, of all the places in Plumeria to visit and sightsee.

There was a burning sensation just behind her ear. She knew what it was, and she ignored it. For five seconds.

Catra tilted her face to glance over her shoulder, and there was Adora staring at her again. She just looked sad, and a little tired, and Catra wanted to go over there and smack her.

Stop looking at me, she growled internally. *We're never going to be friends again*.

But Adora kept looking, Catra kept sneaking looks back, and when they were called to board Catra's body was so tense that she

nearly creaked when she stood. Adora was no longer staring and Catra lined up far behind her, and her traitorous little heart ached for the loss of those blue eyes focused on her.

Fucking idiot, she thought. This was of course aimed at herself.

Adora was the sort of exhausted that made her bones ache. She was up all night thinking about Catra, and then she'd had a night terror that had her screaming herself away. It had been *years* since her last night terror, and the return of it made her nervously check her contacts for her old therapist.

Her old feelings of guilt were coming back, and Adora didn't know what to do with them. Sometimes she would even wonder to herself: *why am I feeling like this?* She was firm in her belief that she had done nothing wrong. Catra was the one being spiteful and vindictive—Adora was just trying to do her job and get this season done.

So why did her heart hurt every time they crossed paths and she saw that hurt, betrayed look on Catra's face?

That night, she'd dreamt they were back in Shadow's home. Shadow used to run them ragged into the early hours of the morning, drilling them until they knew their lines backwards. Catra had already struggled—she was just a tiny kid. The dream had been about the worst incident, where Catra kept forgetting her lines and Shadow snapped. She had slapped her harshly across the face, causing Catra's newly grown fangs to cut into her cheek. Her mouth had bled badly, but Shadow never cared.

Adora woke screaming, the stench of blood in her nose and her limbs tangled in her sheets. She screamed, and the scars at her back ached so badly that she nearly sobbed.

Now, she gratefully sank into her window seat and folded her arms together. She could sleep on this flight at least, and hopefully not have another bad dream. The only people that knew

how she used to be was Razz, Angella, Glimmer and Bow. Filming for She-Ra had nearly destroyed her, and leaving it to join Wolf Spring had been the best decision of her life. She would have done two more films if she hadn't outright quit, and First Ones had spun it that the franchise was merely done.

Wolf Spring had gotten her on the slow climb to finally dealing with and healing from not only her traumatizing childhood, but the trauma experienced during She-Ra as well. Adora was proud of where she was now, and she didn't want all that progress to unravel.

Someone paused in the aisle by her seat, but froze. Adora turned to look, and when her eyes locked with familiar gold and blue, her heart shot into her throat. Catra looked pissed—as usual. Adora opened her mouth to ask why she was just standing there, staring daggers, but then Catra opened the luggage compartment and started roughly shoving her carry-on bag inside. It would be right beside Adora's, and with this realization came the one that they were seated together.

Razz had done this.

Adora peered over the head of the seats and spotted Razz up front, carefully watching them. She flashed a big, goofy grin and yeah, this was all calculated. People seriously underestimated Razz sometimes. She could be pretty cunning.

Catra wasn't saying anything, but she was struggling to get her bag in. She made frustrated grunts and Adora could detect the slight hint of a growl. Her tail started lashing, thumping loudly against the seat behind her and nearly smacking one of their co-stars in the face.

Adora got up quickly. "Let me help."

"No," Catra hissed.

Adora rolled her eyes and ignored it. She tried to bump Catra to the side, but Catra's claws hooked into her bag and she bared her

fangs. “Catra, you’re too short. Just let me help.”

“I’ve got it.”

“No you don’t.”

“I didn’t ask, Adora.”

“Neither did I.”

Adora leaned down into Catra’s personal space, and it did as she had hoped. Catra’s ears folded back and she slid away quickly, hands dropping from her bag. Adora straightened and neatly slid the bag beside hers, then clicked the lid to the compartment closed.

“There,” she said, grinning. “Easy.”

She ignored Catra’s glare and returned to her seat.

“I’m not going to thank you,” Catra growled angrily, sitting down beside her.

Adora’s heart skipped, but she tried to ignore the feeling. She should be horrified to spend the flight beside Catra, not *excited*. Either Catra would ignore her the entire way, or she would make it her mission to be as annoying as possible.

“You’re welcome,” Adora decided to say, just to irritate her a little.

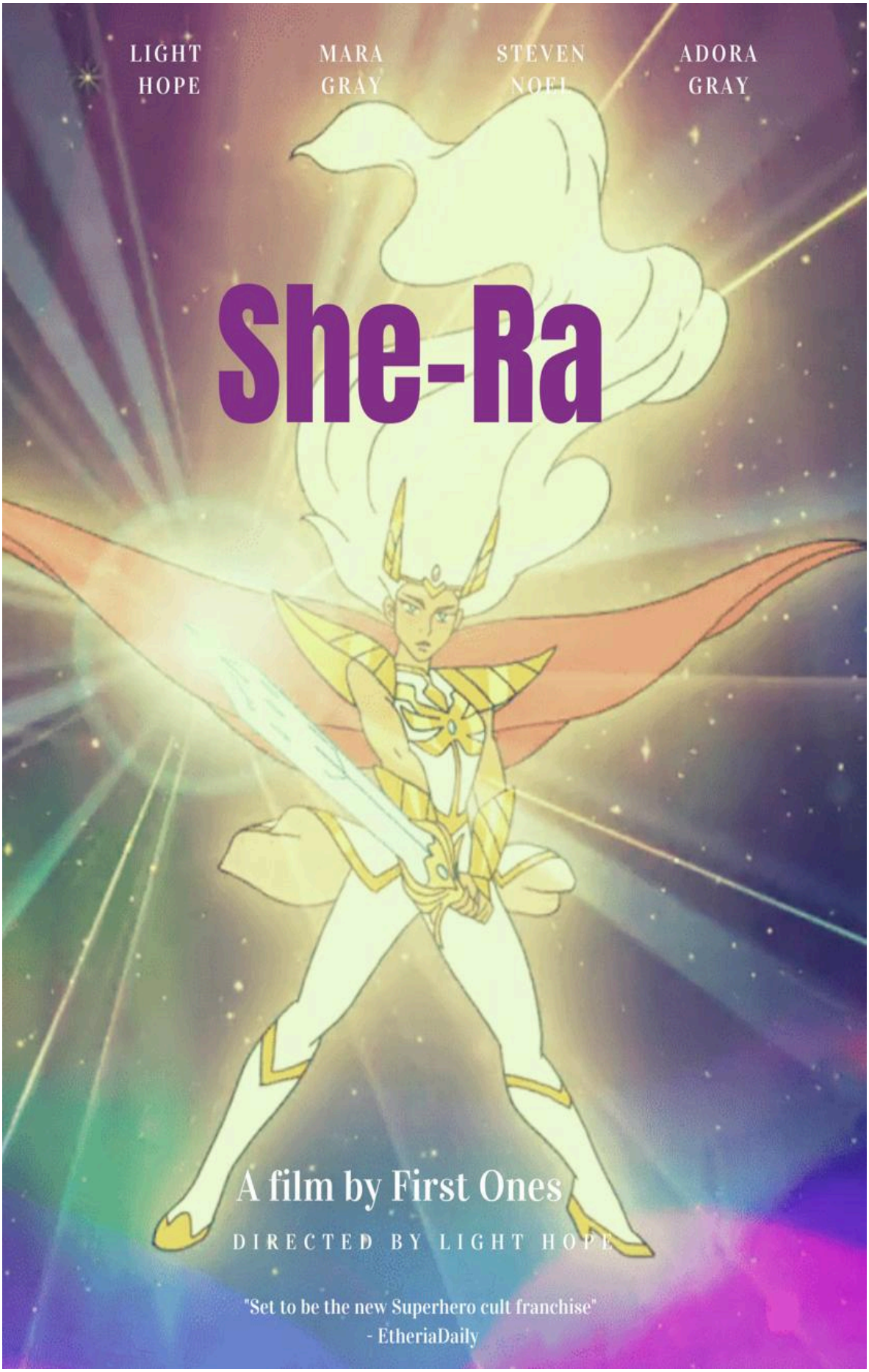
Catra glared at her one last time, then she folded her arms and fixed her eyes forward. Luckily, for the rest of the flight, Catra didn’t even breathe in her direction.

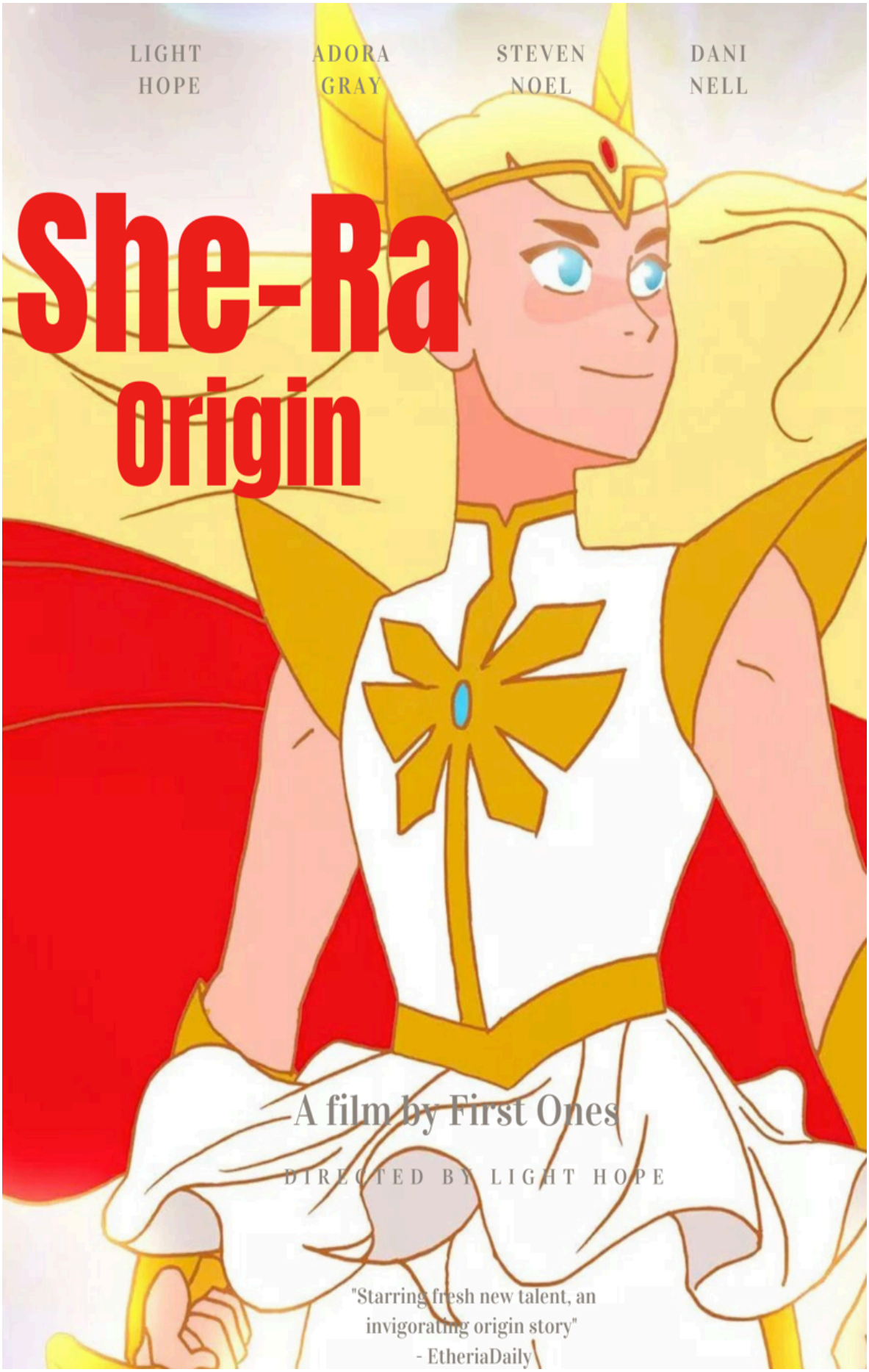
Adora hated that she felt a little bit disappointed, hoping that even with poison laced words, she could get just a little more of Catra’s attention.

Intermission One, She-Ra Promo

Chapter Notes

NB: SPOP Celeb AU twitter has been deleted. All the info posted there will be instead put into the fic itself.


LIGHT HOPE
MARA GRAY
STEVEN NOEL
ADORA GRAY
She-Ra
A film by First Ones
DIRECTED BY LIGHT HOPE
"Set to be the new Superhero cult franchise"
- EtheriaDaily


LIGHT HOPE
ADORA GRAY
STEVEN NOEL
DANI NELL
She-Ra
Origin
A film by First Ones
DIRECTED BY LIGHT HOPE
"Starring fresh new talent, an invigorating origin story"
- EtheriaDaily


LIGHT HOPE
ADORA GRAY
STEVEN NOEL
DANI NELL
"Adora continues to awe in her role as powerhouse She-Ra"
- EtheriaDaily
She-Ra
& the Sword
A film by First Ones
DIRECTED BY LIGHT HOPE


LIGHT HOPE
ADORA GRAY
STEVEN NOEL
DANI NELL
"Yes another breathtaking entry into this spellbinding film franchise"
- EtheriaDaily
A film by First Ones
DIRECTED BY LIGHT HOPE
She-Ra
Fists of Fire


LIGHT HOPE
ADORA GRAY
STEVEN NOEL
DANI NELL
"The end to a journey"
- EtheriaDaily
She-Ra
Endgame
A film by First Ones
DIRECTED BY LIGHT HOPE

Intermission Two, Wolf Spring Season 1- 3 Overview & Promo

List of Wolf Spring episodes

Season	Episodes	Originally released
1	13	June 13, 2016
2	7	June 26, 2017
3	6	July 2, 2018
4	13	July 5, 2019
5	13	July 15, 2020

Season 1 (2016)



No. overall	No. in Season	Title	Directed by	Written by
1	1	"Chase"	Madame Razz	Madame Razz
2	2	"Welcome to Wolf Spring"	Madame Razz	Madame Razz
3	3	"Aiden"	Madame Razz	Madame Razz
4	4	"Way of Magic"	Madame Razz	Madame Razz
5	5	"New Kid in School"	Madame Razz	Madame Razz
6	6	"Howl"	Madame Razz	Madame Razz
7	7	"Friends"	Madame Razz	Madame Razz
8	8	"History Lesson in Cool"	Madame Razz	Madame Razz
9	9	"Werewolf, Werewolf"	Madame Razz	Madame Razz
10	10	"Let Go"	Madame Razz	Madame Razz
11	11	"Breaking Barriers Part 1"	Madame Razz	Madame Razz
12	12	"Breaking Barriers Part 2"	Madame Razz	Madame Razz
13	13	"Alpha"	Madame Razz	Madame Razz

Summary:

Dominique (Adora Gray), a young werewolf who has spent her life hiding what she really is, is discovered by a group of werewolf hunters and pursued. She is at a party in the woods when she is attacked and forced to flee. Dominique manages to get out of her home town by hitching a ride with a friendly trucker. They strike up conversation, but Dominique keeps to herself and falls asleep. She wakes up when they are attacked by hunters. The trucker is killed and Dominique turns into a wolf to defend herself. She is nearly fatally wounded, but once again manages to escape. Dominique stumbles into a nearby town, Wolf Spring, where she collapses in the woods. She is found by a young woman with bright pink hair. Dominique wakes up confused and disoriented to find that her wounds have been healed, but not before dressed. She at first panics, but a girl with bright pink hair enters the room and calms her down. She introduces herself as Sparkles (Glimmer Queen), Spark for short. Spark already knows what she is, and tells her that Wolf Spring is neutral grounds. Hunters are not allowed to set foot on here, and physically can't. Wolf Spring has a coven of witches, of which Spark is part, and they cast protective magic. Dominique is taken in by Spark's coven and starts going to school in Wolf Spring. However, the hunters don't give up and keep trying to get into Wolf Spring. They do eventually manage to take the barrier down, and a group of them sneak in. Spark's coven realizes when the barrier was broken, and they vow to protect Dominique at all costs. A battle follows, where Spark is hurt, as well as her boyfriend, Aiden (Bow Archer). This triggers Dominique's buried power and she defeats the hunters and saves her friends.

Season 2 (2017)



No. overall	No. in Season	Title	Directed by	Written by
14	1	"Berserk"	Madame Razz	Madame Razz
15	2	"Star Crossed"	Madame Razz	Madame Razz
16	3	"Trust Not Given"	Madame Razz	Madame Razz
17	4	"A Plot"	Madame Razz	Madame Razz
18	5	"Throne"	Madame Razz	Madame Razz
19	6	"The Dragon Prince Returns"	Madame Razz, Angella Queen	Madame Razz
20	7	"A Treaty, A Family & A Wedding"	Madame Razz	Madame Razz

Summary:
The Dragon Prince Egan (Rogelio James) has mysteriously gone berserk after the unfortunate death of the Dragon King (Nick Pratt). The Dragon Prince's friends, his personal dragon guard Ash (Lonnie Mark) and his fiancée Keith (Kyle Smith), a human/dragon hybrid, all travel to Wolf Spring to ask the coven there for assistance and Dominique ends up roped in, too. They discover an internal plot in the Dragon Kingdom to tear the royal family apart and pass the throne off, and after discovering and fighting the culprit, Rogelio's uncle Drakon (Daniel Neals), they manage to cure the Dragon Prince of the curse and he returns to his senses. He promises to always give his aid to Spark's coven, and to Dominique, should they ever need it. After peace resumes, Egan and Keith finally wed and the Dragon Kingdom continues in prosperity.

Season 3 (2018)



No. overall	No. in Season	Title	Directed by	Written by
21	1	"Holiday"	Madame Razz	Madame Razz
22	2	"Ugh"	Madame Razz, Angella Queen	Madame Razz
23	3	"Get A Grip"	Madame Razz, Mermista Waters	Madame Razz
24	4	"Ugh, But Louder"	Mermista Waters	Madame Razz
25	5	"In the Depths"	Madame Razz	Madame Razz
26	6	"All In A Day's Work"	Madame Razz, Mermista Waters	Madame Razz

Summary:

After the intense events of season 2, Dom and co decide to go on a little holiday on the coast. There, they discover a pod of beached magical creatures, all dead. Dom can sense something isn't right, and Spark confirms that there's something off about the magic in the ocean. They decide to investigate, and they end up in a battle with Merfolk. It is a misunderstanding, and when they finally communicate that they're not the ones poisoning the water, the person attacking them stops to listen. The person is Aqua (Mermista Waters), Queen of the Merfolk down in Atlantis. She tells them how the waters around her Kingdom have been poisoned and they're trying to figure out by who and why. At first they consider it being simple human pollution, but it is magic in nature. They discover that someone is purposefully poisoning their waters to weaken them in order to steal their Royal Relic, the Trident. The Trident is a magical wonder, able to power their entire underwater civilisation. It is incredibly powerful. A group of mercenaries are responsible, having gotten their poison by a rogue coven. One of the mercenaries, Drake (Seahawk Burk), is captured and held prisoner in Atlantis. Through him they discover the plot and are able to ultimately defeat the mercenaries and the man responsible for sending them, a big Oil CEO.

Take One: Media Frenzy

Chapter Notes

> This fic is officially back from hiatus. Thank you so much for your patience

See the end of the chapter for more notes





WolfSpringLeaks @leakysprings · May 18, 2022

Late news. Cast of Wolf Spring to shoot on location, Plumeria. Flight Leaves 3am tomorrow. Land 5am. Crew at seasons hotel. Shooting at Plumeria Woods, East Side Beach. 😈😜
#wolfspring #wolfspringleak #casdom #adoragray #catracyra

342 771 12.5K



CasDomxx @Casdomismykink · May 18, 2022

if there isnt a scene where Cas chases a half naked Dom through the Plumeria forest then I don't want to hear it

5 11 113



DaddyDominique @daddydominique · May 18, 2022

LMAO leakysprings is the MVP!! I hope we get a dramatic chase scene in the trees

9



CasxDom4evar @CasxDom4evar · May 18, 2022

i am so excited for this season im gonna NUT

2 16 53



foska26 @foska26 · May 18, 2022

wow plumeria fr?

3



ZandileDhlamini @zandiledhlamini · May 18, 2022

i'm living for the juicy drama thank you @leakysprings for giving us the FOOD lmao 😂🤗

1 5 37



QueenCasBDE @QueenCasBDE · May 18, 2022

omg omg omg omg omg GIMME FIGHT SCENES IN THE TREES

2 9 26



jamandbees @jamandbees · May 18, 2022

did y'all know bees get drunk. I swear it. Google that shit

20 2 22

WolfSpringLeaks @leakysprings · May 18, 2022

Late news. Cast of Wolf Spring to shoot on location, Plumeria. Flight Leaves 3am tomorrow. Land 5am. Crew at seasons hotel. Shooting at Plumeria Woods, East Side Beach. 😈😜
#wolfspring #wolfspringleak #casdom #adoragray #catracyra

342 771 12.5K

beatroot001 @beatroot001 · May 18, 2022

I live in Plumeria and can't believe they're shooting in my home town!!! AAAH! I'm going to wait at the airport with my sister and hopefully catch the cast. If I can get an autograph from THE Adora Gray I will simply wilt peacefully and pass on

2 2 21

CasxDom4ever @CasxDom4ever · May 18, 2022

yo miss @beatroot001 can I have that autograph before you pass on or nah. I've been looking for a new tattoo idea..

16 50 399

juliana_T @juliana_T · May 18, 2022

the moment Catra Cyra was leaked as the new queen in S5 I was super excited. Been a huge fan since her earlier indie films. Friday the Clawteenth was cringey as heck but Catra was such a badass that it made the film watchable lol. So glad to see her hired on for this awesome show

32 10 350

luca_M_aximus @luca_M_aximus · May 18, 2022

my body is ready



5 2 37

●●●oo vodafone 8:04 am 69%



#wolfspring #tvtheory #madamerazz #adoragray

Wolf Spring Season 5 | Theories

4.3M views · 1 day ago

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Theory Rounds! What is the Sparkly Gang gett

Up next Autoplay



Wolf Spring Leaks// who is Catra Cyra?
Theory Rounds · 507kviews · 11hr ago



Wolf Spring// how it does queerness right
Theory Rounds · 215kviews · 9hr ago

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Chapter End Notes

Chapter 7 is already partially done. Thank you for reading! Comments are very much loved and welcome

Take One, Kit Cat, There's A Dilemma

Chapter Notes

This fic will update every Sunday.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra hated flying in general, but usually she had Double Trouble to keep her company. DT had a gift for talking the minutes away and making Catra forget that she was in a giant metal tube afloat in the sky. Magicats, Catra felt, were just not meant to be so damn high.

Unfortunately, DT was nowhere to be seen and Catra's companion for the next few churning hours was none other than goddamn Adora. Catra was still seething at Adora forcing her to accept help in getting her stupid bag in the overhead compartment, especially since Adora seemed mighty pleased with herself afterwards.

Asshole, she thought, I didn't ask for your chivalry.

When the plane took off, it took every ounce of self control to not clutch at the armrests with her claws sunken deep as anchors, because if she did that Adora would notice, and if Adora did, she would offer another form of help.

Catra would rather walk off the plane midair.

It was now the end of their flight, at least, but Catra felt highly on edge. The loud noises of the plane's engine and inner workings grated on her sensitive hearing, and the air was humid enough to make her sinus feel raw. The worst part of the entire ordeal was Adora right beside her—warm Adora, napping without a care in the world. Even when they had been kids, Adora had always been able to fall asleep in the strangest places. Catra had envied her, but had found it endearing. Often, little Catra had stolen those moments to watch Adora's peaceful face.

Catra refused to consider this one of those moments. No matter how goddamn gorgeous Adora was, or how nice she smelled. Catra was an adult, and she had self control.

She would not enjoy being this close to Adora.

"Mm, no…" Adora mumbled. She shifted in her seat, her head lolling to the side. A deep furrow formed between her brows, and despite the years between them, Catra still knew exactly what that expression meant. Adora was having a bad dream.

Catra decided she didn't give a shit, and she sent out extra bad vibes in the hopes that Adora's dreams would get worse.

Satisfied at her cosmic bad deed, she settled in more comfortably at her seat. They were approaching Plumeria Airport. Catra couldn't wait to have her toes in the grass and the fresh air on her fur. When shooting ended for this episode, Catra considered asking DT if they could rather just take a hired car and drive back, even if it was at her own expense.

"Catra," Adora mumbled again, a tiny note of pain in her voice.

Catra's heart skipped, but she turned her body away from Adora and towards the aisle, frowning.

Yeah, she needed to take a drive back. Another close quarter 2 hour flight would drive her nuts, especially since the deepest part of her simply wanted to reach out and smooth that furrow away. She longed to let Adora rest against her shoulder, passing whispery breaths against her ear.

Catra groaned. Up ahead, people started talking loudly. Catra's ears pricked forward at the sound of alarm from the crew, and then DT was hurrying over, their heels sounding like the tips of knives driving into steel.

"What's going on?"

"Kit Cat, there's a dilemma."

Catra peered around DT, spotting Razz and Angella talking furiously, heads bent together as they stared at something on Angella's ipad.

"Is the plane about to crash?" Catra asked, only half joking.

"Ugh, worse." DT's eyes narrowed slightly, their inner lids blinking rapidly. Catra lifted a brow, waiting. "Someone leaked our location. We got a call from Plumeria security that there are at least over a hundred rabid fans waiting for touch down."

Catra snorted. "Sucks for Adora then."

Double Trouble's gaze was serious and penetrating. "Darling, those fans are also here for you."

A retort died on Catra's lips, and her eyes widened. "*Oh*, right."

DT rolled their eyes, but it was done with affection. They turned swiftly and strode away towards Angella. Catra watched them go.

Why hadn't she even considered that there may be fans for *her*?

"What's going on?" Adora mumbled, rubbing a hand over her face. She looked half asleep, red lines marred across her white skin and her hair a golden mess.

Catra was still digesting the realization that she probably had fans, so she forgot for a moment to be mean.

"Someone leaked us coming to Plumeria," she told Adora, eyes still trained on Angella, Razz and now DT discussing, likely, what they were going to do when they touched down.

Adora let out a sight. "Was bound to end up on social media."

"Right."

"Part of the job. Will you be alright when we get surrounded?"

Catra blinked. At some point, Adora had leaned over Catra's seat to glance down the aisle. Heat poured off of her, soaking into Catra's very being. Her scent, still so familiar and comforting despite it all, filled every sense Catra had. Her heart thumped unevenly, and memories from their childhood assaulted her without warning.

She remembered all the nights spent in bed with Adora, cuddling as close to her as she could, burying her nose against Adora's throat to inhale as much of her scent as possible; kneading the mattress under them, or sometimes even Adora's body—her stomach, an arm, her back, whichever she needed.

The memory sparked a lot of buried feelings, but the reminder of them made Catra burn with anger. Pain followed closely, and the warmth in her chest turned from affectionate longing to a lava lake of pain and anger.

"Get off me," Catra snarled, a high-pitched growl worming its way between each syllable. Her fur was standing on end, and Catra's ears were pressed flat to her head. Her tail lashed violently against the seat in front of her.

Adora jolted from the growl, and when she sat back her blue eyes filled with hurt. Catra hated that—hated how genuine that hurt looked, and how confused Adora seemed. Was she really so ignorant? Did she really have no idea?

Could she truly never fathom that the *home* of her was what tore Catra up inside?

"Sorry," Adora said. She didn't follow it up with more, and she turned to look out the window, her posture stiff. Her scent was mixing with other familiar things—fear, anger, longing, but more specifically, anger.

Catra let out another low growl, just because she needed to do *something* to settle this roiling within her chest.

They were told to buckle in, so Catra distracted herself with the seatbelt. Her fingers were trembling and her claws would not retract, and even though every cell of her was buzzing with aggressive energy, she couldn't help the slight tug at her heart.

She wanted to apologize. She wanted to turn to Adora, to tell her how she really felt. Ask her all the questions she had been keeping in since they were sixteen and in love and Adora had betrayed her.

They started to descend, but no one in the plane stopped talking. Adora remained glued to the window, but she was bouncing her knee in agitation.

Catra's heart ached. She desperately wanted to sink her claws and teeth into something soft. She wanted arms around her.

She wanted…

She rubbed at her temple where a headache was growing.

It no longer mattered what she wanted. Everything had been ripped from her, and she had given up on Adora a very long time ago.

What she needed to focus on now was herself—her new career, her growing fame, and the groups of fans screaming when they stepped into the airport.

The moment they were able, Adora stood, took her bag and stalked off. Catra ignored her. She didn't stare at her as they left the plane, went to get their bags and made their way to hired cars.

The security had managed to wrangle the fans into the parking area, so the crew were sent to get the cars ready with their gear, and the cast were sent to greet the people impatiently waiting.

Catra froze the second her eyes landed on the huge number of people. Standing in a determined circle right in the centre front,

was a group of teen magicats. When they spotted Catra, they went wild.

Chapter End Notes

Thank you for reading! Comments are always welcome

Take One, Sharing is Caring

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Adora was not in a good mood. On the flight, she'd had a terrible dream where she was hanging over the edge of a cliff, her nails digging into the hard earth, with Catra standing above her. She begged for help, tried to reach out, but all Catra did was sneer down at her. Then her foot came down on Adora's fingers, and when her grip lost all strength and she started falling backwards, Catra spoke. Adora couldn't hear her.

Before she hit the bottom, she'd been woken by their crew talking loudly. At least she hadn't jolted out of the dream, or worse, screamed.

Now she was sitting in the darkly tinted car Razz had hired for them, heading towards Plumeria Heights hotel. Fans and paparazzi had stopped following them not too long ago, and Adora really hoped they wouldn't have any incidents. Their security was always on top of things, but sometimes someone slipped by them and Adora had to deal with her underwear being stolen.

Thankfully Catra wasn't in the car with her. She had stayed behind with her group of magicat fans. She'd refused to leave with everyone else, despite Angela's pleas. Adora knew Catra would be fine on her own, though luckily her manager had stayed behind with her.

Adora smiled, remembering the storm of purring she'd heard from the kids, but more especially the purr she'd heard from Catra. That sound brought a lot of fond memories to the surface, making Adora's heart swell with longing. When they were kids, each night Catra would crawl into her bed and curl mostly on top of her, and

she'd purr the night away. On especially stressful days, Catra needed to knead, and when she did her purr was even louder.

Adora remembered the feeling of Catra's chest pressed to hers, of that purr vibrating through her, soothing her, sending her into a peaceful sleep each and every night despite what waited for them in the morning. It broke her heart to miss it.

Now Adora frowned, the fond memories chased away by the fresh one, of Catra with her teeth bared, a vicious growl in her chest where that innocent, affectionate purr used to be. It made Adora angry, to be treated like that, but it also just made her sad.

Sad for the girl she had loved—the first and only. Where would they be now, if things hadn't gone so badly? Adora wished they had been adopted by someone nice, not taken in my Shadow. She had broken them. She had chipped away pieces of their souls, and they would never get it back. For a while, they had learned to fill those pieces in with each other. But that was never enough.

Adora rubbed at an aching spot on her chest. She decided to cast all thoughts of Catra aside. She still didn't know what the hell happened, or why Catra had changed the way she had. As far as she was concerned, if Catra refused to talk to her like an adult, then she would just carry on like the adult.

Maybe she should also just make a point to avoid her co-star as much as possible, though that seemed near impossible. Razz had a whole range of interviews and photo shoots planned for them, especially now with the leak and the media fury.

"You okay?"

Adora startled. She turned to Glimmer, smiling despite the hurt in her heart. "Peachy. Just perfect."

Glimmer lifted a brow at her. "Everything okay with you and Catra? Heard some whispers from the crew after we landed."

Adora groaned. "Of course. Nothing's ever private."

“Not when you’re Adora Gray,” Glimmer snorted. “I swear, I still don’t understand why the women go so crazy for you.”

Adora bumped their hips, forcing herself to grin rakishly. “It’s my muscles, Glim.”

“What, not your charming personality?”

They laughed, and Adora felt the knot in her stomach slowly loosen. She had a little history with Glimmer. A one-sided crush, an attempt at a relationship and a heartbroken conclusion to a relationship that never would have lasted. But then Bow came into the picture, and Glimmer had one look at his exposed abs and she was over the heartbreak and ready to try again.

“But seriously,” Glimmer said, “what’s the deal with you and Catra? She’s seriously funny. I mean, she’s a bitch, but a funny bitch.”

“It’s a long story.”

Glimmer took her hand and gave it a squeeze. “Okay, but if you need me to kick her furry ass, you tell me. That’s not a request, either. It’s a threat.”

Adora snorted. The rest of her melancholy melted away. Bow joined them, having eavesdropped from behind. They chatted about the flight and the things they wanted to do in Plumeria before their return flight on Sunday, and Adora allowed herself to slip back into normalcy with her co-stars and friends.

The crew checked in at the hotel and were given their keycards for their rooms. All of the main actors were given suites, and as soon as Adora got her keycard she gave Glimmer and Bow each a hug and then headed to her room.

It was only 6am, and they needed to meet on location at 8 for a quick table read for their re-worked script, and then they needed to film. Everyone hoped they would wrap up key scenes by

Sunday, so that they could relax a little before returning to Brightmoon.

The chatter of the crew died away as Adora headed down a hallway and then stepped into the elevator. She got out at floor 23 and quickly found her room, 23F.

It was a spacious suite, sporting a large bathroom with an enormous bath that could fit at least five people, a kitchenette area with a full mini bar, a big bed also for those five people, and then a balcony with a beautiful view of Plumeria in its glory. The suite was a mix of crisp white and dark black, and Adora felt comfortable immediately. She first unpacked her bag, never liking to keep her things in her luggage even if she was only staying a couple days, and then she started the bath and ordered room service. Within ten minutes her food arrived—a bacon, egg and avo wrap, with a steaming cup of rooibos tea infused with chamomile. It was Adora's favourite, especially when she was struggling with anxiety.

Back when Mara first figured out the extent of Adora's issues, having this specific brand of tea while they sat and watched the waves, Adora either staring quietly, or sobbing, was how she settled her thoughts and her heart.

She had roughly an hour to eat, dress and head to location. The bath was ridiculously luxurious, but Adora didn't take too long to linger.

The sooner they could shoot their scenes and finish up this episode, the sooner she could get home. Better yet, the sooner they finished this damn season, the better. Adora really needed to see Mara.

"I must say," DT purred, their tail doing a languid sweep behind them, "I never pictured you for the maternal type, but I think it fits."

Catra didn't take offense to the remark at all. In fact, it hadn't been meant as an insult. She gave Double Trouble a wide grin, showing off the points of her fangs. She was absolutely delighted, which was evident by the rumbling in her chest.

"Can you blame me?"

DT's smile was oddly affectionate. "Not in the least, Cupcake. Motherhood becomes you."

Catra snorted. "Okay, I'm never having kids of my own. Forget that weird little train of thought."

"And why would you decide that? You're wonderful with kids."

Catra shrugged. "They're fans, it's different. Besides, they were all *magikittens*. Do you realize what this means, DT?"

"That you have become the very face of magicat representation, despite being a bitchin' villain in a teen drama show."

"Well, yeah, but I'm also playing the role of a take-charge, strong badass magicat *vampire*. Do you know how rare that is?"

"Darling, have you seen how green I am? There are even *less* like me on the big screen." DT sauntered over and slid an arm over Catra's shoulders. "But I am delighted. You deserve the praise, Catra. They deserve to have you represent them."

Catra flushed. She could feel the warmth bloom across her entire body. Rarely did she ever get such praise, and while DT nearly took praise giving as a kink, this was different. It was serious, and it was proof that despite everything, Catra had done it. The season wasn't even out yet and she already had this many fans, and *this* many who were magicats.

Growing up, Catra had only ever had humans to look at in the movies and shows that she watched. Rarely ever was a hybrid cast in a role like hers, as a vampire. Those sorts of roles, werewolves and vampires and the like, were always given to

humans. They were like a blank canvass. Less scales, less fangs and fur and glowing eyes. It was easier to put those on them, than it was to just hire an actual hybrid.

A tiny part of Catra was nervous—that she would mess this up, somehow, or that she wasn't truly worthy. But then she thought back to the group of kids that had basically kissed the ground she walked on. Remembering their happy, glowing faces and the awe in their eyes made Catra that much more determined to do her damn best, and *be* the best.

"*You are worthless, child. Not just to me, but to everyone. Only Adora knows why I still clothe and feed you.*"

Shadow's words still haunted, but Catra could finally feel those long, acrylic nails retract from the scruff of her neck. This was proof that Shadow was wrong. Catra was worth it. She was worth a damn lot.

She no longer needed to wait on Adora's every breath to prove her worthiness. Adora was nothing to her. Catra could stand on her own two feet, everyone else be damned.

Except the magikittens. They could do whatever they wanted and Catra would support them.

After hanging out with her young fans, she and DT went to the nearest café outside Plumeria airport. Now their coffees were drained, so they had to head to the hotel to deposit their bags before they could meet with the crew for filming.

Honestly, Catra was excited to find out how this scene had changed. There was certainly a chase scene, but that had originally been scripted in alleyways. Now they were probably going to shoot it in Plumeria Woods, where Catra could go apeshit wild and swing in the trees.

"Have a little tea before it's time to shoot," DT told her as they prepared to part ways to their suites. "Heard rooibos is relaxing."

Catra rolled her eyes, but there was a smile on her mouth. DT took the next left, and Catra the right. The elevator up was quiet, and Catra took the time to think over her fans. She would never have the words for it, but their adoration meant so much to her. If anything, she would perform to perfection just for them.

Her chest swelled when she imagined a little magikitten watching the show, seeing someone like herself playing such a strong character, and feeling like she had strength and power even in such a human dominated world.

The warm emotions stopped abruptly, however, when she swiped her keycard and pushed the door open.

Catra froze in the doorway.

Blood rushed across her cheeks in a furious blanket of heat.

She was greeted by a pair of gorgeous breasts, just out in the open, nipples pointed right at her.

Those breasts belonged to Adora.

Adora—dear Lord—was standing by the mini bar, in *Catra's* suite, naked save for the towel loosely draped over her shoulders.

Adora's head snapped up, her impossibly blue eyes widening to saucers. Adora's scent thickened, and Catra could hear the way her heartbeat kicked into gear. Bright scarlet dusted over Adora's chest and face, making the pink of her nipples stand out starkly against her white skin.

"Catra what—"

"What the fuck are you doing in my room? *Naked?*"

Adora gasped loudly, affronted, only then gathering the sense to cover her naked chest—forget her naked everything else.

"Excuse me, *your*—"

"Yes, *my* room, Adora."

"This is my room!"

"Like hell it is!"

Adora dropped her arms, exposing her breasts again, but Catra refused to look away. Adora then stormed towards her, and Catra straightened her spine, tail flicking, expecting a physical confrontation.

Instead, Adora threw the door closed, then leaned against it with her broad back. Catra was not letting her eyes rove over every exposed bit of skin she could see. She was just… looking. Not at anything in particular. Not at her t—Catra growled low in her chest, turning away from Adora to clear her head and gather herself before the anger took control.

She had been looking forward to relaxing until she had to head to location for their brief table read. Now she was stressed out and angry.

And she had the image of Adora's bare boobs in her mind.

"This is my room," Adora insisted. "Why are *you* here?"

Catra snorted. "Did all the fame suck out what little common sense you have? This is my room. I literally just unlocked it." She lifted her keycard, where it had the number 23F printed in bold alongside the barcode.

Adora stared at it, brows furrowing. "There must be some mistake then." She pushed away from the door and lifted her own keycard from the bar counter.

Sure as shit, it said 23F on there too.

"I'm going to kill someone," Catra growled, for once not aiming it at Adora.

Chapter End Notes

Updates every Sunday

Intermission Three, Wolf Spring Season 4 Info

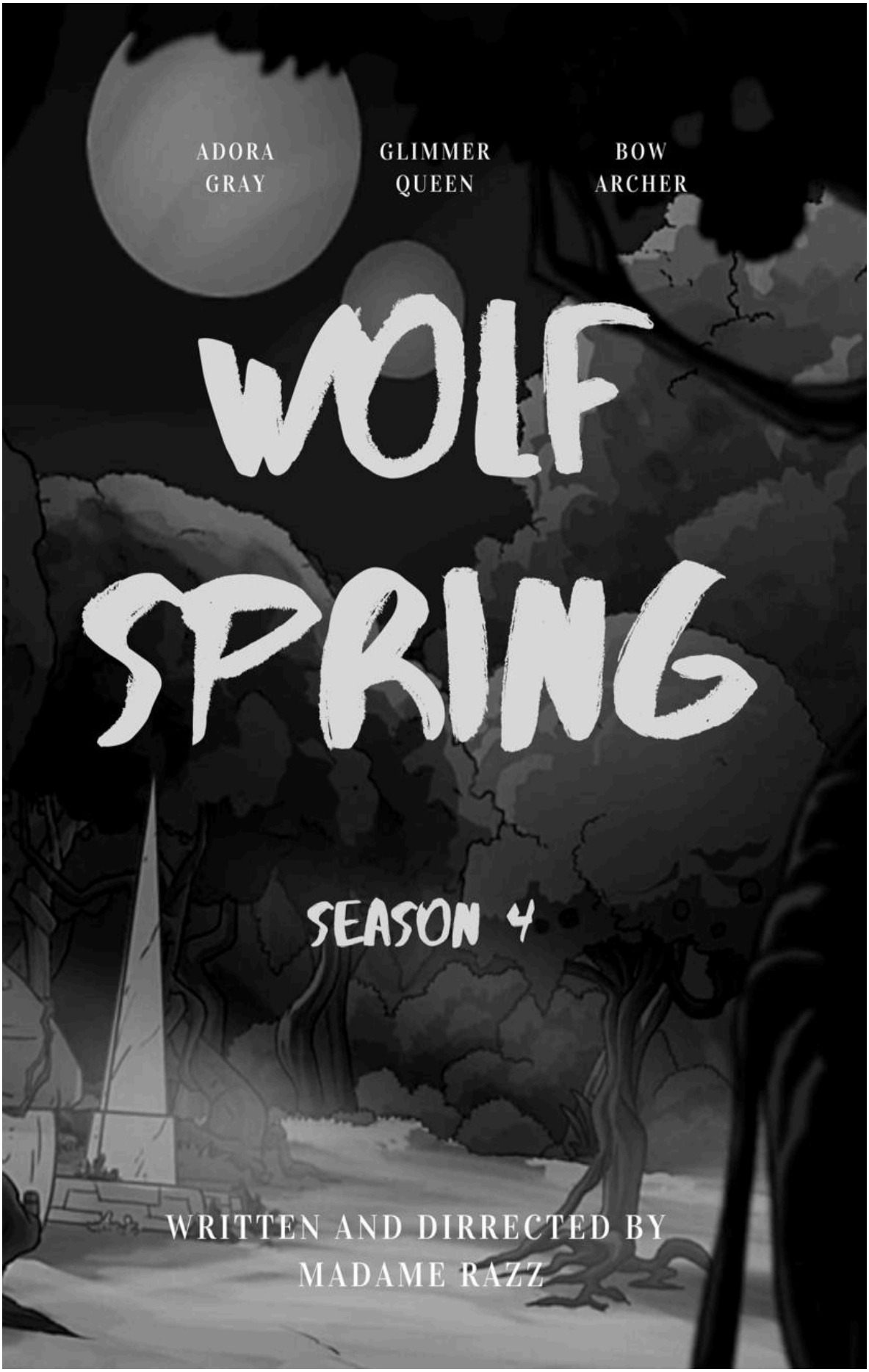
Season 4 (2019)



No. overall	No. in Season	Title	Directed by	Written by
27	1	"The Future"	Madame Razz	Madame Razz
28	2	"Looking Around"	Madame Razz	Madame Razz
29	3	"As I Said"	Glimmer Queen	Madame Razz
30	4	"Under the Moon"	Madame Razz, Adora Gray	Madame Razz
31	5	"Inheritance"	Madame Razz	Madame Razz
32	6	"The Hunt Begins"	Madame Razz, Johan van Ness	Madame Razz
33	7	"Discovery"	Madame Razz	Madame Razz
34	8	"Dominique Who?"	Madame Razz	Madame Razz
35	9	"Growing Pains Again"	Madame Razz	Madame Razz
36	10	"A Wolf Knows, A Wolf Doesn't"	Richard Schoeman	Madame Razz
37	11	"Semi-Secret"	Jackie Koertzen	Madame Razz
38	12	"To Arms!"	Madame Razz	Madame Razz
39	13	"Queen Shall Rise"	Madame Razz, Jennifer Nell	Madame Razz

Summary:

The year comes to an end, and Dom and co. are looking forward to their grade 12 year end function, and to graduating. Dom is struggling to figure out what she wants to do with her life after school, while Spark and Aiden have decided to attend university within Wolf Spring. The night of the year end function, someone is attacked and drained of their blood. Dom pursues the person, but they flee. It is revealed that there is a vampire in town, and there's something about this situation that makes something within Dom awaken. They go on the hunt for this rogue vampire, but uncover a strong coven passing through, and there is a big battle. During this battle, Dominique awakens some of her power and discovers that she has bloodlust, but she does not tell anyone, afraid of what this news will do. They defeat the coven, but know not who the mastermind is behind their actions. One of the dying vampires does tell them that a new Queen will rise, but that is all they manage to get out. The season ends on an ominous note, and a hasty graduation.


ADORA
GRAY
GLIMMER
QUEEN
BOW
ARCHER
WOLF
SPRING
SEASON 4
WRITTEN AND DIRRECTED BY
MADAME RAZZ

Take One, And There's Just One Bed

Blood trickled over the slope of Adora's nose, tickling her lips on its way downward. Her face contorted in pain, but there was anger in her eyes, in her chest, and she straightened to her full height.

Catra stood in front of her, even more furious. Blood dripped from the tips of her claws.

"You'll regret this," Adora said, her voice a deep growl of anger.

Catra's ears twitched forward, her body shifting, knees bending. She was gearing up for a fight, and that was exactly what she would get.

"I regret nothing, Princess," Catra spat back, her eyes flashing with danger.

Adora gritted her teeth, even though she knew she shouldn't. Her hands clenched into tight fists, nails biting into the meat of her palms. She flexed her calves, eyed Catra's claws again, and then she shot forward.

Expecting her, Catra bounded backwards. She was far faster than Adora, despite the boost that anger gave her. When Adora finally caught up, they crashed together in wild fury. Catra swiped at her face again, but Adora dodged with quick reflexes. She wrapped her arms around Catra's slim body, lifted her right off her feet and then pushed her against the nearest surface.

She put her face right in front of Catra's. "Let's talk about this."

Catra snorted. Her tail whipped at Adora's side, stinging her hip. "Bite me."

A hand suddenly clamped around Adora's throat, squeezing tight. Catra had managed to wiggle her way free, and with her strength she easily overpowered Adora, and sent her down to her knees.

She released her grip. Adora took in big gasps of air, but then her face was shoved into the ground, the pattern of Catra's boot likely to leave pink lines across Adora's cheek.

"Beg for mercy," Catra snarled, her words dipped in pure, unfiltered hatred.

Despite everything, and much to her own embarrassment, Adora flushed with arousal.

"CUT!"

Catra immediately lifted her foot off of Adora, her cheeks filling with heat. She could smell Adora's excitement, and she knew the exact moment that had affected Adora.

Images from that morning flashed in her mind, of Adora's nudity and their confrontation. Her tail swayed in irritation, and she crossed her arms over her chest, adopting a neutral expression.

"I didn't hurt you, did I?" she asked, refusing to watch Adora climb back onto her feet.

"Uh, no—no, I'm fine."

Her voice sounded very not fine, and her scent deepened with embarrassment. Catra forgot that Adora was the one human on this planet that would never forget that she was a magicat, and what that meant—that she could very easily detect certain scents.

She was tempted to mock Adora for getting turned on by the scene, but she decided not to. Part of her wondered if it was because it was them doing the scene, or if maybe Adora had picked up some interesting kinks in their long years apart.

"Catra, I—"

She ignored Adora and walked off the set. It was already late into the night, but she was sweating underneath the stuffy wig they

put on her. She ripped it off and approached the snack table. DT was there, scrolling on their phone and nursing a cup of coffee. When Catra paused by the table, DT glanced up at her.

"You won't murder each other when it comes time to sleep, will you?"

Catra let out a sigh. "No," she snapped. She knew Double Trouble wasn't at fault. They had been accidentally booked into the honeymoon suite together, and with nearly their entire crew on location, there were no other rooms she could take. Catra also didn't want to cause a huge fuss, despite how upset she really was.

She hadn't shared a room with Adora since they were 16.

"Good," DT told her, grinning. "I'd hate to lose my favourite client."

Catra rolled her eyes. "Your only client."

"But the best I've ever had."

Catra piled a plate with mini baked goods, sliced fruits and cake. She also grabbed a cold bottle of water, then plopped down on a chair to eat. Nearby, one of the people from makeup was giving her a glare, so she ate as fast as possible then went to have her wig put on again and her appearance neatened.

In the same trailer, Adora was getting her fake wounds tended and the blood wiped away. Her blue eyes burned across the space between them, like she had a million words to say but was keeping them all back.

Adora had always been good at that—not saying the thing that mattered, when it was needed most.

Razz called for them to shoot the final scene one last time. Sighing, Catra stood and followed Adora to their marks.

Even though she should have enjoyed it more than usual, pretending to claw Adora in the face made her chest clench tightly. Though it was covered in makeup, Catra could see the slight bumps of the real scars on Adora's face.

"Get ready," Angella yelled at the staff.

Catra swallowed her anxiety, reminded herself that she was above feeling sorry for Adora ever again, and then the scene began.

The last time around, Adora didn't get quite so excited, but the memory of when she had was burned into Catra's sinus.

They finished the final scene just past 1am, much to Adora's relief. This time they hadn't needed to reshoot because of messed up lines, but because Razz kept insisting on multiple takes, "just in case, dearies."

Now that her work for the day was done, Adora felt exhausted. Her muscles ached from the fight scene she had to reenact over and over again, and other parts of her ached too, much to her horror.

God, how was it that she got off on that scene? Being under Catra's boot, literally? It was embarrassing, especially since she knew for a fact that Catra knew. Adora had wanted to apologize to her, but Catra brushed her off and ignored her.

For the best. It saved them having yet another confrontation, because Adora could only imagine the nasty things Catra would say to her. Especially now, with Catra being extra pissed off.

Adora wanted to head to Razz and explain the mixup with their room, but she didn't want to cause any trouble. She didn't want people to think that she despised Catra, since that was so far from the truth.

Adora frowned. She was in the car, on the way back to the hotel. Catra was nowhere to be seen, and part of Adora hoped that she

would find somewhere else to sleep. She thought about earlier that day, when Catra had walked into the room, and Adora had been naked.

Her cheeks burned red, even so many hours later. Adora covered her face with a hand.

How could she be so stupid sometimes?

The anger of Catra barging into her room had taken center stage, making her forget that she was completely naked. The thing that did remind her was Catra's shocked expression, and then the way her eyes roved over Adora's exposed body, like she was too stubborn to even look away.

Adora didn't care that she had looked, only that it was embarrassing over all. Catra hated her, and now she'd seen her boobs. Adora groaned. She buried her face in both hands, wishing she could erase the memory from her mind—but another part of her, the one that was still so hung up on Catra, delighted in it.

Adora did not, in fact, listen to that naughty voice. It would do bad things to her if she did.

At just before 2 in the morning, Adora took the elevator up to her room. The whole way her stomach cramped with nerves, but the heat between her legs hadn't gone away. She thought of every horrible thing that she could—especially Shadow—but none of it helped to calm her down.

Catra stepping on her, quite literally, had just done something very sinful to Adora.

Nothing sounded more heavenly than collapsing in bed, closing her eyes and having a solid, dreamless sleep for the next couple of hours until her alarm woke her for a new day of work. Adora could already feel the warmth of the blankets around her, just imagining it, but her breath froze on her lips when she entered the suite.

No one was naked in the room this time.

But Adora could hear the shower running, and Catra's clothes were strewn across the floor, creating a path that led to the bathroom. A surge of irritation shot through her at the clear disregard and the messiness, but then she reminded herself that Catra had always been like this. Or at the very least, she was doing this now to annoy her.

Sighing, and pointedly not acknowledging that Catra was naked just in the next room, Adora went to the cupboard to get her sleep shirt and cotton boxers. She dressed as quick as lightning, cheeks warming just at the very slight risk of Catra suddenly throwing the door open and seeing her naked back.

Adora wondered how Catra would react, seeing her back.

The shower stopped. Adora held her breath, heartbeat thrumming. Her mind raced, wondering how their next confrontation would go.

The door opened quietly, and the room was silent enough that Adora's human ear could pickup the sound of Catra's soft footfalls. She wasn't able to stop herself, and glanced over her shoulder. Her heart skipped.

Catra was frozen in the doorway, steam billowing out of the room behind her. She had on an oversized shirt that hung down to mid-thigh, and that left quite a lot to Adora's imagination, wondering if she was wearing anything else. She knew how much Catra hated clothes in general, and that she used to enjoy sleeping in nothing but her skin.

"What are you staring at?" Catra snarled at her, tail flicking.

Adora's cheeks burned, but she didn't look away. Catra's fur was damp, slicked down in places where it was longest. A few beads of water collected at a tuft of hair at Catra's elbow, and Adora swallowed thickly as she watched the drop dive for the ground. Silently, Catra watched her as Adora stared right back.

The memory of their one and only time making love flashed through Adora's mind, making her temperature hike even more. It had been only a few days before their split, and though it had been fumbling and awkward, for Adora, it had been the best she'd ever had.

Catra snorted. She strutted past, nearly brushing right against Adora on her way to her still full suitcase beside the bed. Adora didn't turn this time, suddenly dizzy from the smell of Catra's clean fur. All she heard were the sounds of aggressive zipping and Catra's tail whacking the floor. She hesitated, wondering if she could say something now, anything pleasant, to turn this terribly awkward night into something that could fix this fissure between them.

Why do you hate me so much, Catra? she wanted to ask.

"Fucking hell, Adora," Catra growled, straightening. Adora looked at her again, her entire body flushed. "Can you seriously not right now?"

Adora's throat felt swollen, but the arousal clouding her mind and body slowly lifted enough to let the anger in. "I'm not doing anything."

Catra tapped her nose. "You are driving my fucking nose crazy."

She knew what Catra meant, and it made her horrified. Instead of being the bumbling idiot that 16 year old Adora used to be, she straightened to her full height and squared her shoulders. She stared down at Catra, injecting as much aggressiveness into her posture and expression as she could. In response, Catra's tail gave a wicked whip and a low growl started in her chest.

"Then mind your fucking business," Adora snapped right back, "or better yet, pack your shit and find somewhere else to sleep."

Catra's eyes widened in outrage. "Are you seriously trying to kick me out of *my* room?"

“It’s not yours.”

“Yes, it is. I’m not going anywhere.”

Adora gritted her teeth. She felt childish and foolish. Where had that desire to be placating gone? Hadn’t she wanted to try and amend things? Catra was just too infuriating, and with her in that large shirt, looking so goddamn beautiful, Adora couldn’t think straight.

“I’d rather share this bed with literally anyone else.”

Catra’s ears pressed flat to her head. Adora immediately regretted the words, but they were already out. She was embarrassed and flustered, and Catra just turned her into just as much of a meanie.

Eyes narrowed to slits, Catra stalked closer. Her steps clicked beneath her as her claws tap-tapped against the floor. Her hair, still halfway damp, puffed up at her forearms and the back of her neck. Swallowing, Adora took a few hearty steps backwards, but Catra just followed until she was pressed up against the wall beside the bed. Catra slammed a fist against the wall next to Adora’s head. Adora thought she heard a crack in the concrete.

“Why are you trying to hurt me?”

The words were soft, but severe. Adora studied each of Catra’s eyes, swallowed up whole by them. Her body was buzzing, alive. She could feel how hard her nipples had grown, and knew they were very much visible.

Why was this turning her on? Why did her body have to betray her like this?

“I don’t want to hurt you,” she finally answered, her voice breathless.

Catra’s body was trembling, her tail flicking back and forth. “So, what,” she said, “do you just have a kink for magicats, then? Huh? Or do you like your lovers to kick your ass?”

Adora blinked. She opened her mouth, but Catra barrelled on. She leaned in close, her fur tickling Adora's bare thighs.

"Typical of you, Adora, to want something you shouldn't. Is it a challenge to you? Do you want to prove something to me?"

Adora sputtered. "What are you talking about?"

Catra let out a loud bark of laughter. "You're pathetic," she said, "getting so turned on and for what? Because I stepped on you? Because I'm in *just* a t-shirt? Have you no shame?"

That single word bounced around in Adora's head—*just* a t-shirt.

She licked her lips, warring with her instincts to fight back, to shove Catra away from her. She wanted to flee the room and nurse her embarrassment and shame, but she was furious now. How dare Catra mock her like this?

Was it not obvious how Adora still felt, despite everything? She could not close her eyes without seeing Catra's face. Even in the moments when she was angriest, she still craved for her touch. No one had ever filled in the space Catra had left, and Adora never wanted anyone to. It was a place carved out just for Catra, and it would always be there, waiting to either gather cobwebs, or to be filled again.

"You drive me fucking crazy," Adora finally told her, words quivering with tension.

Catra's eyes bore into hers, face filled with anger. She parted her lips, revealing the sharp points of her teeth. Adora stared back, daring Catra to be the first one to start this fight, or to leave.

Those eyes flicked down to her lips, then to her throat. Catra leaned in even closer, a steady growl still vibrating in her chest, and Adora knew she should be afraid. Catra was a dangerous predator, and Adora knew very intimately how deeply her claws and teeth could go. But there was nothing left in her but aching *want*.

“I drive you crazy?” Catra breathed. Her words washed over the side of Adora’s jaw, making her swallow. Catra lifted a hand to her throat. Trembling fingers clamped down, but didn’t squeeze. Adora should have thrown her hand off and shoved her aside, but she was no longer in control of her body. It was infuriating and embarrassing, but it just was. “You destroy me,” Catra told her in a mean snarl, her nose curled in disgust.

Adora blinked at her, chest squeezing. Hurt mingled in with the hot mess of her emotions, and then they crashed together in a kiss so violent that Adora’s shirt tore from sharp claws and her back slammed into the wall.

It was so sudden, and she wasn’t certain who moved first, but it no longer mattered.

Growling, Adora lifted Catra into her arms and twisted them around to have Catra between her and the wall. Catra’s strong legs wrapped around her waist, pulling them impossibly close.

The kiss was all consuming and molten, driving out every last one of Adora’s senses. She let out a soft moan, and Catra’s tongue slid forcefully into her mouth.

Her taste was home. Her heat was everything.

Gasping, Adora kissed her harder, gripped onto her tighter, and grinded their bodies together.

“Adora,” Catra cried into her mouth. The single word was the sweetest thing she had ever said.

Take One, So Bad But So Good

This was bad. This was so, so very bad. But it felt so good.

Catra moaned louder than she intended—in fact, hadn't intended to make any noises at all—as Adora's lips decimated her. The scent of their arousal clung to Adora's skin, already made salty with a light sheen of her sweat. She tore her mouth from Adora's, pleased at the angered growl Adora gave her, and dipped down to run her tongue along Adora's throat. The roughness of her tongue made Adora shiver, goosebumps breaking out on her soft skin. The taste of her was intoxicating.

How had Catra ever convinced herself that she could live without this, without *her*?

"Catra," Adora panted, more words clearly to come, but Catra didn't want them to talk. She wanted no words, except her name, maybe.

She wanted Adora to scream her name to the heavens. The desire was festering, crawling under her skin, beating against her already racing heart.

"Shut up," she commanded before kissing Adora again, hopefully wiping all the language from Adora's mind.

It worked, and she was rewarded with a lustful moan. Adora's large, strong hands felt as if they were burning where they clutched at Catra's hips. She wanted those hands all over her, running over her fur, her skin, her everything. The force of her need was overwhelming.

Clearly just as taken by the moment, Adora suddenly pushed away from the wall and had Catra on the bed. Their bodies pressed together, Catra's t-shirt riding up to her stomach, exposing her naked lower half. Adora didn't look, yet, and she didn't even reach out. Her hands were firmly planted against the

big mattress to either side of Catra's head, but her hips she pushed forward, pressing against the soaked heat between Catra's thighs.

She was getting too hot—feverishly hot. With a cry of frustration, she started pulling at her shirt even as Adora still attacked her lips with a single-minded focus. Eventually she realized what Catra was doing, and she finally sat up, straddling Catra now, and helped to pull the shirt free.

Everything had happened so quickly. Now that there was a bit of space between them, and Adora's tongue wasn't in her mouth, they were faced with the option of acknowledging what was happening. Catra didn't want that.

As soon as her shirt was tossed to the floor, they locked eyes. Adora's were so very blue, and so beautiful. Catra missed the days when Adora had looked at her like a lovesick puppy. When that colour of blue had made her stomach flutter and her chest fill with warmth. Now, those eyes were looking at her with unconcealed want—it didn't matter what sort of want, if it was purely sexual or not. Having that look directed at her made Catra want to fall apart at Adora's feet. Her heart ached.

And her arousal did, too.

Catra bit down on her lip to get rid of her melancholy, then swiftly pulled Adora's shirt off. She nearly let out a gasp of pure awe at the planes of muscles, but she also noticed the scattering of pink marks. They were scars, and they looked bad. She reached out and traced the worst scar, the one that sat directly above Adora's heart. Her fingers were shaking, and her sadness threatened to return and overtake her.

"If I need to shut up, then you need to stop looking at me like that," Adora told her. Her voice was soft, but it was filled with bitterness.

Catra swallowed, eyes narrowing. Not one to let her emotions win—besides the very specific ones she wanted—she cupped the back of Adora's head with her hand, fingers burying in her short, thick hair, and forced her down until their lips reunited.

Adora's hands were on her then, exploring every inch of her. She moaned and she gasped, lost on the building tension. Somehow, even after all these years, Adora still knew how to pleasure her.

She knew that the base of her tail was exceptionally sensitive, and that when it was touched in any sort of way during sex, it was as good as touching her clit. Adora's tongue laved across her throat and her chest and her breasts, despite the short fur covering her skin.

Adora's warm mouth covered one nipple, then the next, and she bit down just hard enough to cause an exquisite flash of pain that had Catra melt into an aroused mess.

Even during their frantic movements, where Adora's mouth and hands covered her and tasted and touched, Catra still noticed the scarred over wounds on Adora's body. Her hands felt the lifted ridges across Adora's back, and her imagination wondered at how bad they were.

The scars made Catra's protective instincts kick in, and so instead of tearing into Adora with her claws and her teeth, she simply clutched at her, shaking. When Adora finally slid into her with two fingers, Catra came embarrassingly fast, but Adora didn't stop or slow. Adora barreled on, suckling and biting down on a spot where Catra's shoulder met her neck, and the dual sensations were amazing.

Without much more, she tumbled into a second orgasm, head thrown back and face contorted in ecstasy.

"Adora!" she screamed, unable and unwilling to care that she had lost the battle with the urge to shout, and that anyone could hear them if they were paying any sort of attention.

All Catra could think about was the woman above her, inside of her, and the lips that were now resting at her head. Adora panted softly and finally stopped thrusting her fingers, but she didn't pull them out yet. Catra didn't want her to—didn't want to lose this intimate connection so soon. It costed her greatly to admit that to herself, but she had let Adora use her body, and there was no turning back.

Her pulse beat rapidly in her chest, and it took many minutes for her breathing to fall back under control. Catra hadn't come that hard in, well, years. Her many lovers after Adora never could compare, and especially not now.

Fuck, what had she done? Why had she allowed this? Catra wanted to sob. She wanted to shove Adora away from her, flee from the room and hide somewhere dark and cramped so that she could lick her emotional wounds and remind herself how Adora had hurt her, and why doing this had been such a stupid idea.

"Catra," Adora uttered softly, her voice cracked and husky. Growing angry now, Catra blinked her eyes open and fought through the orgasmic fog hiding her sensible thoughts away.

She was about to say something truly unforgivable, but Adora was leaning over her, still inside of her, shoulders heaving slightly from the exertion. Her pupils were blown wide, and she was still very clearly aroused, but Catra saw on Adora's face something that made her want to rage.

Tenderness.

Just like that, she decided she no longer cared. She decided that she would tear herself up as many times as she needed just to experience this, *Adora*. She would selfishly take what she could, what she wanted.

And right now, all she wanted was Adora.

Adora's head was swimming. Catra's scream still rang in her ears. She couldn't believe this was actually happening, that the two of them were naked and intertwined, and that she had just made Catra come so hard that she threw her head back and yelled.

Adora never knew Catra could be this vocal, and she loved it. This was so very dangerous.

Catra was gasping softly, her chest heaving as she tried to catch her breath, and Adora hungrily watched her. She committed every second of this to memory, certain that the second Catra had taken her pleasure, she would react badly and they would never have this again.

She would never have Catra.

Sadness filled her and made her heart ache. Adora was a compassionate lover, and it pained her not to show her gentleness and her care. She wanted to softly caress the slope of Catra's cheek. She wanted to kiss her gently and whisper how much she cared—because she did, goddamnit.

With pained clarity, Adora realized that she was still very, very much in love with Catra, despite it all. She had spent many years trying to rid herself of these feelings, but no matter what, she couldn't.

Catra had been her first, and Adora had to accept that Catra would be her last.

"Catra," she said, studying Catra's face in concern.

For a moment, Catra looked into her eyes and it felt as though their differences, their conflict, no longer mattered. Catra stared at her with pain and longing and Adora was sure her own expression was the same.

She opened her mouth to say more, desperate to try, to do anything, to fix this. But then she was pushed onto her back and

Catra was on her, a hungry beast suddenly uncaged. Adora's words died on her lips, and she moaned out into the cool air.

Catra trailed her rough tongue along her throat, biting down here and there hard enough to hurt just right, but not enough to leave a mark. When she reached Adora's breasts, she didn't hesitate to draw a nipple into her mouth and lave that wicked tongue over the stiff tip. Adora's back arched, but Catra was strong and kept her pressed to the bed.

That's how it went, Catra driving her absolutely wild, and Adora falling apart more and more. When Catra finally settled between her thighs, Adora watched her bite down at her slick thigh, and she couldn't help the gasp she let out.

When Catra's tongue finally swept through her, Adora lost her voice, her sense of time and self. Her orgasm was sudden and intense, pulsing through her as fast as the sliding of Catra's tongue. Like her attitude, Catra was wicked. She didn't let up, not for a second, even when Adora's fingers buried in her short hair and pulled. She couldn't help it. Couldn't stop herself from tugging, from grinding herself harshly against Catra's mouth. Desperate, she chased her second orgasm, her third, her fourth. Her fifth tore through her when Catra pushed two fingers into her, curled upwards to glide against her front wall.

This time, Adora shouted. She didn't care if anyone heard. She didn't care that this very moment would destroy her, in more ways than one. All she cared for was the woman she loved, leaving soft kisses against her inner thighs as she quivered and whined through the dissipating avalanche of sensation.

When the powerful orgasm faded, Adora just let her head collapse against the pillow. Luckily their position had ended in the right spot on the bed. Her limbs were liquid, and she was spent. If she was even able to move, she wouldn't want to.

Catra crawled along her body, and then she kissed her—it was hard, and possessive, and it made Adora throb *again*. Catra finally

released her, then she collapsed on top of her, a tell-tale rumbling in her chest.

Adora blinked up at the ceiling, sight blurry. There was so much she wanted—needed—to say. She wouldn't get to now. Overwhelmed from the pleasure, from her emotions, Adora slipped into unconsciousness.

Catra's heart was pounding. She had decided to end this in the cruelest, angriest way she could, but when Adora had shouted that last time, Catra couldn't help but drink in the way she shuddered in pleasure, and the way she seemed far too vulnerable for the strong woman she had grown into.

The euphoria faded fast, leaving Catra reeling. She shouldn't have kissed Adora's thighs after as she recovered, or crawled back up her body, or kissed her again. She should have rolled away, given a grunt of thanks for the good fuck, then gone to sleep.

Now she was lying on top of Adora, enjoying the softness of her body, and fucking purring like a kitten. Her face grew warm with shame, anger and embarrassment.

"Adora, I—"

What should she say? She knew she had done too many things, shown too much in her body language, for Adora to think this was just a one-night thing. She wanted it to be a forever thing. Her heart was stubborn, never having grown up with her. No matter how much anger and spite she filled it with, her heart always kept a big space open for the love she held for Adora.

She could do it now—finally talk. She could ask Adora why she had betrayed her like that, and then pretended she didn't know. She could finally tell Adora how much her leaving had hurt.

Shaking with nerves and emotion, she lifted herself up, the first sentence already gathering like acid on her tongue, but then she froze.

Adora was asleep.

The purr stopped abruptly, and Catra's ears pressed flat to her head. She felt foolish—incredibly foolish. One night of great sex wasn't enough to bridge the gap between them.

This had been a mistake. An impulse taken over.

Furious, battling tears, she rolled off of Adora and the bed, and hurriedly collected her clothes from the floor. She dressed, not even looking if she was putting things on correctly, and then she grabbed her suitcase, all her stuff that she could find, and fled.

The door slammed behind her.

Take One, Flashback

Sixteen-year-old Catra sat in the passenger seat of Shadow's convertible, shaking with excitement. Catra couldn't get her body to calm down, even though Shadow kept sending her nasty looks. Her face was pinched in the way that told Catra she was very unhappy with something and was trying to think of ways to give out punishment for it.

This time, Catra hadn't done anything wrong. In fact, for once in her life, she had actually done something *right*.

"I can't believe I got it," she found herself saying aloud. The silence in the car was usually welcomed, but Catra couldn't keep this to herself.

"A fluke," Shadow said, her lip curling.

Normally, the comment would have been crushing to Catra's confidence and happiness, but this time it didn't have the desired effect. Instead, she gave Shadow the happiest, biggest grin she could.

"I'm going to play She-Ra!" she shouted happily, fists thrust into the air.

"Quiet," Shadow hissed at her. "You're being a nuisance."

Catra only laughed softly. Shadow's foul mood couldn't take this from her. Nothing could. Catra was buzzing with happiness. She still couldn't believe it, actually.

First Ones had reached out to Catra first, offering the role. Catra almost never found out, if not for her habit of sneaking through Shadow's emails and stuff. Apparently, they wanted to have a hybrid lead, and one that was a magicat specifically.

The role wasn't super big. She would play as the sixteen-year-old version of the superhero She-Ra, in a brand-new movie franchise.

It was based on the incredibly popular comic series. There were no hybrid leads in the comics, but that didn't matter. They were pushing for something fresh and new, and apparently Catra was it.

When she'd found out, she had been too happy to care that Shadow had taken her sweet ass time to tell her. Then they went to meet with the studio, and Catra was asked to audition. She was barely a page in when they told her she was perfect for the role, as they had suspected.

She couldn't wrap her head around it. That they had seen some of her poorly done work, and despite that, they'd seen *her*, the talent and the drive.

It had taken years and years for Catra to get over her stage fright and her social anxiety, and she was so glad she had pushed through it all. Even though Shadow should have been overjoyed—after all, this was what she pushed them for—she was instead huffing and sighing as though this was the most annoying thing in the world.

It was whatever, Catra knew Shadow hated her. She didn't care, because she was going to be playing goddamn She-Ra! She would have to figure out a way to make sure most of the money she made from this didn't go to Shadow.

She could save them. She could take this money and Adora, and they could find a place together and do auditions together and be free and happy.

Catra thought about that weekend, when they had been making out on Adora's bed, and the kissing had turned to nervous touching and then to, well... it was the best night of Catra's life. Her eyes filled with tears, brimming with liquid happiness, and she wanted nothing more than for Adora to pull her into a hug.

She craved Adora's familiar scent and the softness of her skin. She decided that the first thing she would do with her money, was buy

a gift for Adora. There was a really cool baseball jacket that Adora had been whining about for weeks. It was insanely expensive, but that didn't matter.

Catra would have the money for it soon. She couldn't conceal her grinning even if she'd tried.

When they got to Shadow's house, Catra bounded from the car and headed to the room she shared with the girl she was stupidly in love with.

Adora wasn't there, and her scent was faint enough to tell that she'd been gone since morning. She was probably out for another audition. Catra's chest swelled again, thinking that Shadow had been with *her* this time for an audition, and not Adora.

For the first time in her life, Catra was glad to be alive.

Since Adora wasn't home, Catra decided to clean their room. After that, she did a bunch of research on First Ones and all the movies they'd made. She also read up on the comic series, and she was just about finished reading the first volume on some pirate website when she heard the front door bang open down the hallway. She recognized Adora's footsteps and breathing pattern, and she perked up on her bed.

When Adora rushed into their room, she was beaming. Her face was flushed red, even to the tips of her ears, but Catra could only smell the adrenalin of pure joy and elation from her. Without being able to stop, Catra grinned right back.

Adora must have found out that she got the part!

"Catra, you won't believe it," Adora began, her words nearly mashing together in her rush to get them out.

Catra laughed in delight. "Yeah?"

Adora's head bobbed as she nodded. There was so much excitement in her blue eyes, and she looked achingly beautiful like

this. Adora was gorgeous, and strong, and Catra's favourite person in the world. But Catra hardly ever saw Adora actually happy. She was always worried, and tense and she cried a lot. So, it was a gift, to see this. Catra's chest felt too tight with warm emotions.

"I was rushed to a new audition. Pulled right from the other one I was going to, the one for that stupid horror movie?"

Catra stilled.

"Anyway, I was basically whisked away to this other audition. You've probably heard about it, it's for a super popular series!" Adora continued talking, not noticing that Catra's happiness had vanished. That her eyes were now wide with disbelief, with fear. "I was a little sceptical, but then I did it! I got the part, Catra! They mentioned something about needing to rewrite some of the script for me, but they want me that badly! How crazy is that?"

Catra's ears pressed flat to her head. Her tail slumped down against the mattress. Adora finally noticed that she wasn't responding, so she glanced over with a question on her face.

"What is it for?" Catra asked her, voice nearly muted. Her vocal cords felt taut, constricted. Her eyes started burning.

"I'm going to play a really cool superhero," Adora told her, not even trying to hide her happiness. "She-Ra!"

If Catra had ever wanted an answer from the universe on if her suffering would ever end, then this was it. She felt as though the floor had fallen out from beneath her. Adora noticed her expression, and she came over, frowning.

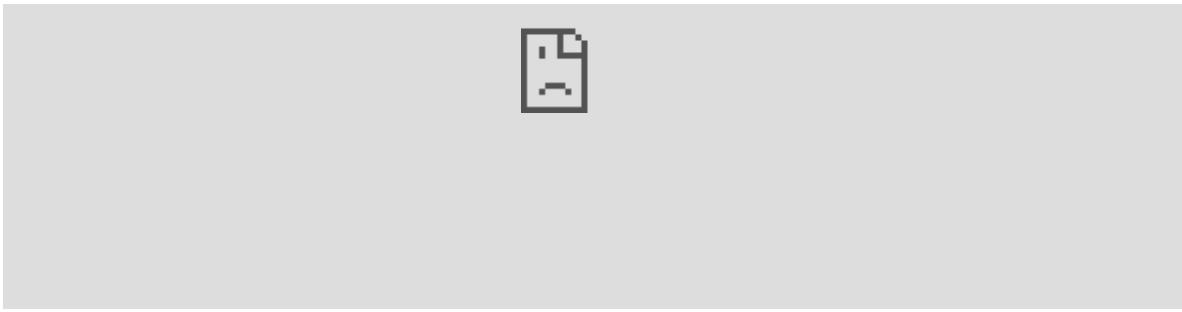
"Catra, what's wrong?"

She reached out to caress Catra's cheek, but Catra screamed and lashed out. Her claws caught Adora under the jaw, slicing through her smooth skin. Adora went down with a yell and her blood sprayed in the air.

There was a roaring in Catra’s ears. She couldn’t hear what Adora was yelling at her, or what Shadow was saying when she rushed in to see what happened. All Catra could understand was the acute, biting sensation of pain. The betrayal destroyed her.

From that day, she refused to even look in Adora’s direction. After Adora’s betrayal, Catra’s life ground to a complete halt, and she was cast out as if she was nothing. Not even the rats in the alleyways wanted a thing to do with her.

Take One, Aftercare



Catra never had any grand expectations when it came to her birthday. Usually, no one in the group home with her cared. No one except Adora, and even then, it wasn't like Adora had any money or power to do anything for her. If Shadow found Adora hoarding money to buy Catra a gift, it always ended in punishment.

So Catra learned to accept that her birthday would pass as just another regular day.

That still didn't prepare her for her seventeenth birthday—homeless, starving and soaked through in the icy rain.

Since ending up on the street, the days had passed by in a blur. Catra had noticed the date on an electronic billboard near the bridge where she slept in a pitiful shelter made of boxes, plastic and a musty blanket. When she'd seen the date, a pit had opened in her stomach. She thought of Adora, of the small celebration that Adora would have insisted on having for her in secret, and her heart ached.

Then she thought about Adora stealing that role from her and ultimately being the reason she was out here, starving and freezing to death. The sadness turned to anger, the anger to fury, then the emotions just left her. She was so tired. Exhausted to the bone, the soul. Her entire life so far, for just a measly 17 years, had been miserable.

The only bright spark in her life had been Adora, and now she had lost that, too.

Catra's shelter had been washed away by the floods of water cascading down the hills around the bridge. It was still raining heavily, so she had no choice but to run for the business district and take cover under one of the roofs. She happened to stop in front of a small pastry store, and the scent of freshly baked treats made her eyes fill with tears and her stomach cramp terribly. Water dripped from her fur, pressed it flat to her skin. She hugged herself and crouched down, silent sobs wracking through her.

What had she ever done to deserve this?

"What's a kitten like you doing out here alone?"

Catra startled and fell over onto her backside. The voice sounded amused, and though the stranger was staring at her with a sharp toothed grin, Catra could smell worry in the air. They were androgynous, with tight pants and sharp heels. They wore a black shirt with fishnet in front, showing a flat, green chest and dark green nipples.

Catra blinked. Her tail flicked, drops of water flying through the air.

"My name is Trouble," the stranger told her, crouching down so that their eyes were level. "Double Trouble."

Catra swallowed. "What the hell kind of name is that?"

Her voice was hoarse from disuse, and it held an embarrassing quiver thanks to the cold. Catra started shivering badly, the water in her fur slowly solidifying into ice.

Double Trouble smirked wider. "Spicy," they said. "I like you." They looked around as if expecting an adult to be lingering nearby, ready to claim ownership of Catra. There was no one besides the two of them, and with Catra's hollow cheeks, ragged clothes and chattering teeth, it was obvious that she was homeless.

“Come with me,” they said, standing. They offered a fluffy coat that was hanging over their arm. Catra stared for just a moment, and then she scrambled to grab the clothing and stuffed her arms into it. It was still warm, and it held the scent of this strange person, but in that moment, it made Catra feel at ease.

“Why?” she asked, pulling the collar up against her freezing cheeks. “Why are you helping me?”

Double Trouble looked at her silently with slitted eyes, then their expression softened, saddened. “I know what it feels like, Kitten.”

Catra sucked in a breath. Her knee jerk reaction was to hiss at this person and to run away with their coat. But she ignored it, and instead considered a possibility where things didn’t end so badly for her. She didn’t know why this person was helping her, but she figured anything was better than what she already had. Not that she had anything left at all.

Prepared for anything, Catra nodded once and then took a step forward. “Catra,” she said, sniffing indignantly. “My name isn’t kitten and I’m not a child.”

Double Trouble let out a delighted laugh, and then they put a hand to Catra’s head, acrylic nails stroking through her wet fur. Strangely, it wasn’t such a bad feeling.

Catra followed Double Trouble home, and the rest was history.

Every breath felt like an effort through crushed lungs as Catra ran through the hallways of the hotel. The one and only place she wanted to go to was DT, and luckily, they were still awake when she banged on the door. They were in a flowing silk gown with a giant goblet of red wine in hand, but when they saw her distress, DT set the glass aside and pulled her into a tight embrace.

“What happened, Kitten?” they asked, voice soft and concerned.

Catra buried her face against DTs chest and started to sob. It was embarrassing, but she felt as though everything inside of her had broken. She had held onto so much of her pain and trauma, and now it was all making her crumble into pieces. DT knew how to calm her down, and so pulled her over to the couch and let Catra curl into a ball on their lap. They gently stroked the fur at the back of her neck and started humming softly. The vibration was soothing, and the familiar scent of DT's clean skin and favourite perfume helped to lift the fog of depression from Catra's mind.

Shaking, furious for her weakness, Catra finally gathered herself enough to pull away and wipe her wet face. DT only looked at her with patience and understanding. It was strange sometimes, to have someone like this who wasn't waiting for any little reason to belittle and punish her.

DT didn't say anything, just kept stroking her fur and looking at her with compassion. Eventually, Catra had the strength to nod that she was alright, and DT's hand pulled away.

"Tell me what's wrong, dear heart," DT said.

Catra took in another shattering breath. "I fucked up so bad, DT."

Their eyes widened as they likely guessed exactly what she meant, but they didn't interject. Catra didn't want to say it. Didn't want to acknowledge what she had let herself do—let Adora do to her.

"I fucked up," she repeated, tears squeezing out of her sore, red eyes.

DT's gaze turned questioning, and when Catra nodded, they scooted closer and hugged her again.

"Oh, Catra," they said softly. "Everything will be alright, I promise that. Once the storm clears, there is always an abundance of growth to follow."

She wanted to be pessimistic. She wanted to hiss and yell that there was no way she would ever be alright. But she knew DT. She knew that when they made a promise, they meant it.

She gave another little nod.

"Let's get you showered and into bed."

Without a word, and with her heart bleeding, Catra allowed DT to care for her. When she fell asleep, she couldn't get her thoughts to quiet down. Her mind kept racing, but she always ended up back on the same image of Adora's face, her smile crooked and her eyes a clear, beautiful blue.

She nearly cried again, but found she had absolutely no tears left to give.

Adora woke and was sure that she had just had the most amazing dream ever. But the evidence was on her body and on the sheets. She tasted Catra on her tongue, could smell her in the air even with her dull human senses. Her muscles ached and above all, she felt a satisfaction that she hadn't felt in a long time. And then astonishment. Then euphoria.

That quickly turned into despair when she gathered the courage to reach out for the body that should have been in bed beside her, but only found empty sheets. She sat up in a rush, startled, and realized that all of Catra's things were gone. All that remained was the afterimage of her, burned onto Adora's skin.

The first thing she did was get really angry, but the more the thought about it, the less anger she felt compared to the overwhelming sadness and hurt.

Had Catra just used her and left?

Why was it that all Catra ever did was break her heart, and then disappear without warning? Even all those years ago, Catra had done the same. She had attacked Adora, then refused to speak to

her despite Adora getting such an awesome role, and then one day her things were gone and Shadow said Catra had run away.

Adora had spent a lot of time looking for Catra, but she never found her. And then she got wrapped up in She-Ra, in new pains and traumas, and she learned to forget.

Now all she could do was remember. She now knew the sounds that Catra made. The way she tasted. The sensation of her warmth, of the shudders through her body. Nothing would ever be the same again, and Adora was devastated. Her emotions crashed into her like a suffocating black wave, cutting off her air and sense of self. She couldn’t breathe, couldn’t think. She managed to get to her bag and her stash of pills, and took one that would calm her down.

She slumped there on the ground, naked and ashamed. She felt repulsive and pathetic, and despite them being years healed, the scars on her back throbbed as if they had been split open anew. Softly, Adora sobbed.

Then she called Mara.


WolfSpringLeaks @leakysprings · Feb 2, 2023
LEAKED! Backstage shots of #WolfSpring S5 filming leaked on location at #plumeria. View them [here] #wolfspringleak #casdom #adoragray #catracyra
108
52
588
BOB/ @hi_my_name_is · Feb 2, 2023
omgggg #hyped #wolfspring
beatroot001 @beatroot001 · Feb 2, 2023
Wow! Amazing to think I've been in those very same woods!! Also???? the boot?? in her face??? im-
OtakuFR @otaku4evarrXD · Feb 2, 2023
ngl this looks like the new season is going to be so awesome XDD
jamandbees @jamandbees · Feb 2, 2023
omg season 5 is going to be so good. also! did y'all know there's a bee called the teddy bear bee? Whack
QueenNyxia @Q_ueenNyxia · Feb 2, 2023
There is so much power in a hybrid in such a role, with her boot literally on someone's face. That power pose? That smirk? I feel so represented and maybe a little in love with Catra and Cas! (I lied: a lot in love)
bigot @bigotkun · Feb 2, 2023
why do we have to have a hybrid in every damn show? it's like they wanna take over and just make hybrid shows. MAKE YOUR OWN STUFF #bigmad
ArcTheeFree @arctheefree · Feb 2, 2023
@bigot is your skull actually devoid of naught but wilted cabbage? Do your two braincells desperately try their best to create a spark within which you can forge a thought: ergo, this one?

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